A history criterion for the non-axisymmetric part of a viscous flow

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Abstract

We give a sufficient regularity criterion when the angular mean of a three-dimensional Navier–Stokes velocity satisfies prescribed anisotropic bounds. The additional hypothesis is finiteness of the critical $L^2_t L^\infty_x$ norm of the angular fluctuation. Its Reynolds stress vanishes in the anisotropic ancient limit without differentiating the fluctuation. A circulation barrier for that limit eliminates the swirl; a cylindrical stretching identity then closes the full-velocity enstrophy estimate using small mean derivatives. We also give a separate quantitative gradient-history estimate and exact finite-energy examples of both signs of kinetic transfer between the mean and the fluctuation. The proof adapts the axisymmetric argument of Constantin, Ignatova, and Vicol. This is an analytic conditional criterion, not a Lean theorem or an arbitrary-data regularity proof.

1 Statement

Let $Q = B(1) \times (-1, 0)$ and let (u, p) be a suitable weak solution of

$$u_t + (u \cdot \nabla)u - \Delta u + \nabla p = 0, \qquad \operatorname{div} u = 0,$$

smooth on compact subsets of Q. Assume the usual local energy class $u \in L^\infty_t L^2_x \cap L^2_t H^1_x$ and $p \in L^{3/2}(Q)$. For rotations Q_ϕ about the fixed third axis put

$$\mathcal{P}u(x) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} Q_\phi u(Q_\phi^{-1} x)\, \mathrm{d}\phi, \qquad v = \mathcal{P}u, \qquad w = u - v.$$

The same notation denotes the induced action on tensors. Write $r = |x'|$, $z = x_3$, and $\tau = -t$. Unless a smaller ball is specified, suprema are on $B(1)$.

Theorem 1. *Suppose $0 < h < 1/2$ and, for every $a + b \le 2$,*

$$|\partial_r^a \partial_z^b v_r| \le C \tau^{-1/2 - a/2 - (1/2-h)b}, \tag{1}$$

$$|\partial_r^a \partial_z^b v_z| + |\partial_r^a \partial_z^b v_\theta| \le C \tau^{-1/2 - h - a/2 - (1/2-h)b}. \tag{2}$$

Set $K(t) = \|w(t)\|_\infty$. If

$$\int_{-1}^0 K(t)^2 \, \mathrm{d}t < \infty, \tag{3}$$

then $(0, 0)$ is a regular point of u.

The mean bounds are those used in [1]. Their validity and (3) are hypotheses, not consequences of the energy inequality. The axis and the ball are fixed; the theorem makes no assertion about propagating approximate symmetry from a shrinking core. No derivative or torque integral of w is assumed. The proof uses the full second-order swirl bounds in (2); it does not extend the meridional-only variant of [1, Remark 5.2] to this setting.

Corollary 2. *In Theorem 1, either of the following bounds near zero suffices in place of (3):*

$$K(t) \le C\tau^{-\beta}, \quad 0 \le \beta < \tfrac{1}{2}; \qquad K(t) \le C\tau^{-1/2}\log(e/\tau)^{-p}, \quad p > \tfrac{1}{2}.$$

These implications follow by integrating K^2 and restricting to a final cylinder. In particular no gradient estimate is inferred from an amplitude bound. A stronger weighted amplitude condition does pay a gradient history in the whole-space setting; that independent estimate is in Section 6.

2 The mean equation and its rescaled stress

Rotation covariance and $\mathcal{P}w = 0$ give the exact equation

$$v_t + (v\cdot\nabla)v - \Delta v + \nabla\mathcal{P}p = F, \qquad F = -\mathcal{P}[(w\cdot\nabla)w] = -\operatorname{div}\mathcal{P}(w\otimes w). \tag{4}$$

The proof retains this divergence form and does not require an L^∞ bound on F.

The original solution has a regular spherical annulus inside any prescribed interval of radii. Indeed, partial regularity makes the top-slice singular set have zero $\mathcal{H}^1$ measure. Its image under $x \mapsto |x|$ has measure zero, so some intervening sphere is regular. Compactness and interior estimates give an annulus on which u, ∇u, and $\nabla^2 u$ are bounded through the endpoint, as in the first part of [1, Lemma 3.2]. Its rotational invariance gives the same bounds for v and w. This argument uses suitability of u; it does not require a partial-regularity theorem for (4).

Write the meridional entries of $\mathcal{P}(w\otimes w)$ in the cylindrical frame as $a = R_{rr}$, $b = R_{\theta\theta}$, $c = R_{zz}$, and $d = R_{rz}$. Their absolute values are at most K^2. Direct differentiation yields

$$F_r = -a_r - (a-b)/r - d_z, \qquad F_z = -d_r - d/r - c_z, \tag{5}$$

$$\frac{(\operatorname{curl} F)_\theta}{r} = \left(\partial_{rr} + \frac{3}{r}\partial_r - \partial_{zz}\right)\frac{d}{r} + \frac{1}{r}\partial_{rz}(c-a) - \frac{1}{r^2}\partial_z(a-b). \tag{6}$$

The quantities here are smooth at the axis in the appropriate lifted variables. For a distributional estimate it suffices that $d = O(r)$.

Consider the rescaling used in [1, Section 4]: for $t_n \uparrow 0$,

$$\tau_n = -t_n, \quad \lambda_n = \tau_n^{1/2}, \quad \delta_n = \tau_n^h, \quad \mu_n = \lambda_n/\delta_n, \quad r = \lambda_n R, \quad z = z_n + \mu_n Z, \quad t = \tau_n s.$$

The mean components are normalized as $V_n = \lambda_n v_r$, $W_n = \lambda_n\delta_n v_z$, $S_n = \lambda_n\delta_n v_\theta$, and the potential vorticity as $\Omega_n = \lambda_n^3\delta_n(\operatorname{curl} v)_\theta/r$. For a stress component a, let a_n denote its composition with this change of variables, without an amplitude normalization.

Lift $R = |X|$ to four radial dimensions. Since

$$\frac{1}{R}\partial_R H = \operatorname{div}_X\left(\frac{XH}{R^2}\right) - \frac{2H}{R^2},$$

the rescaled forcing in the potential-vorticity equation is

$$\begin{aligned} G_n = \lambda_n^2\delta_n\Big[&(\Delta_X - \delta_n^2\partial_{ZZ})(d_n/R) \\ &+ \delta_n\partial_Z\left\{\operatorname{div}_X\frac{X(c_n-a_n)}{R^2} - \frac{2(c_n-a_n)+(a_n-b_n)}{R^2}\right\}\Big]. \end{aligned} \tag{7}$$

Both R^{-1} and R^{-2} are locally integrable in $\mathbb{R}^4$. The divergence identity has no axis-supported mass: the flux through $R = \epsilon$ is $O(\epsilon^2)$ for bounded H. Move all derivatives in (7) onto a compactly

supported smooth test function with time support $J \Subset (-\infty, 0)$. The resulting absolute value is bounded by

$$C_J \lambda_n^2 \delta_n \int_J K(\tau_n s)^2 \, \mathrm{d}s = C_J \delta_n \int_{\tau_n J} K(t)^2 \, \mathrm{d}t \longrightarrow 0. \tag{8}$$

Thus no derivative of the fluctuation is needed in this part of the limiting argument. In a recentered zoom with $r = \lambda_n(A_n + R)$ and $A_n \to \infty$, the azimuthal-vorticity force has the same prefactor $\lambda_n^2 \delta_n$ multiplying at most two derivatives of the stress; its additional coefficients $(A_n + R)^{-1}$ and $(A_n + R)^{-2}$ are uniformly bounded on compact sets. Estimate (8) therefore applies there too.

3 Eliminating the ancient swirl

Lemma 3. *Let S on $[0, \infty) \times \mathbb{R} \times (-\infty, -1]$ have uniform spatial $W^{2,\infty}$ bounds on compact time intervals, be continuous through the upper time, and satisfy $S(0, Z, s) = 0$. The drifts V, W may be only measurable in time, but are uniformly bounded and spatially Lipschitz on each such interval. Suppose, for $R > 0$,*

$$S_s + V S_R + W S_Z + (V/R) S = S_{RR} + R^{-1} S_R - R^{-2} S \tag{9}$$

in distributions. If $h > 0$ and

$$|S(R, Z, s)| \le C(-s)^{-1/2-h}, \qquad |V(R, Z, s)| \le C_r(-s)^{-1/2},$$

then $S = 0$.

Proof. Put $\Gamma = RS$. Its equation on $R > 0$ is

$$\mathcal{L}\Gamma := \Gamma_s + V\Gamma_R + W\Gamma_Z - \Gamma_{RR} + R^{-1}\Gamma_R = 0.$$

For $L > 1$ let $B_L = CL^{-1/2-h}$ and

$$\Phi_L(R, s) = B_L R + C_r B_L \int_{-L}^{s} (-q)^{-1/2} \, \mathrm{d}q.$$

It dominates $|\Gamma|$ at $s = -L$, and

$$\mathcal{L}\Phi_L = B_L\big[C_r(-s)^{-1/2} + V + R^{-1}\big] \ge 0.$$

Comparison is valid on the unbounded spatial domain. On a fixed slab $[-L, s_1]$, perturb Φ_L by

$$\eta e^{k(s+L)}(1 + R^2 + Z^2).$$

The radial diffusion of R^2 is zero for this operator, so k can be chosen in terms of the bounded drifts to make the added function a supersolution. Its quadratic growth dominates the linear growth of Γ at infinity. Near the axis, $\Gamma = O(R^2)$ uniformly on this slab, while $\Phi_L \ge B_L R$. Thus one can excise a sufficiently small axis cylinder, on whose boundary comparison already holds. On the remaining bounded region the positive-part energy argument applies: spatial Lipschitz bounds control the divergence of the drift, and no diffusion in Z is needed. The distributional equation and spatial second-derivative bounds give local bounded time derivatives, so the time traces used in this argument are legitimate. This also justifies the argument for time-measurable drifts, as in [1, Lemma 3.3]. Let $\eta \downarrow 0$ and apply the comparison to both signs of Γ. For a fixed (R, Z, s) it yields

$$|\Gamma(R, Z, s)| \le CRL^{-1/2-h} + 2CC_r L^{-h} \longrightarrow 0 \qquad (L \longrightarrow \infty).$$

The upper time is included by continuity. □

To apply the lemma, first take a limit of the actual mean swirl equation. Write $e = R_{r\theta}$ and $f = R_{z\theta}$ for the corresponding entries of $\mathcal{P}(w \otimes w)$. They obey $|e| + |f| \le 2K^2$, and

$$F_\theta = -\partial_r e - 2e/r - \partial_z f.$$

In the preceding rescaling the swirl equation is

$$\begin{aligned}(S_n)_s + V_n(S_n)_R + W_n(S_n)_Z + (V_n/R)S_n = (S_n)_{RR} + R^{-1}(S_n)_R - R^{-2}S_n + \delta_n^2(S_n)_{ZZ} + H_n,\\ H_n = -\lambda_n^2\delta_n[\partial_R e_n + 2e_n/R + \delta_n\partial_Z f_n].\end{aligned} \tag{10}$$

For a rectangle $D \Subset \{R > 0\}$, a closed time slab $J = [-T, -1]$, and finite p, this gives

$$\|H_n\|_{L^1(J;W^{-1,p}(D))} \le C_{D,J}\delta_n \int_{\tau_n J} K(t)^2 \, \mathrm{d}t \longrightarrow 0. \tag{11}$$

The mean hypotheses uniformly bound V_n, W_n, S_n in spatial C^2 on this slab. All other terms of (10) are bounded in a negative Sobolev norm. Thus the time increments of S_n in that norm are bounded by $C|s - s'| + \epsilon_n$, where $\epsilon_n \to 0$. Interpolation with the spatial bounds gives asymptotic equicontinuity in C^0; spatial interpolation then gives locally uniform convergence of the first spatial derivatives too. Finitely many initial members are smooth, so this yields the usual compactness after a subsequence. The selected time $s = -1$ is included. The bounds $S_n(0, Z, s) = 0$ and $\|\partial_R S_n\|_\infty \le C_J$ extend the convergence to the axis. Also $\partial_Z S_n(0, Z, s) = 0$ and the mixed second derivative is uniformly bounded.

The drifts have weak-* limits, with the same global spatial Lipschitz bounds on each compact time slab. The strong convergence of S_n and its first derivatives permits passage to their products with these drifts. Equations (10)–(11) give (9) in the limit. The backward bounds are

$$|S(R, Z, s)| \le C|s|^{-1/2-h}, \qquad |V(R, Z, s)| \le C|s|^{-1/2}.$$

Their constants are independent of the compact spatial set. Lemma 3 therefore makes this limit zero.

For a recentered zoom with $r = \lambda_n(A_n + R)$ and $A_n \to \infty$, replace every curvature factor $1/R$ in (10) by $1/(A_n + R)$. The force estimate still holds on each fixed rectangle, and the limiting equation on $\mathbb{R}^2$ is simply

$$S_s + VS_R + WS_Z = S_{RR}.$$

Its bounded solution tends uniformly to zero in the remote past, so [1, Lemma 3.3] makes it zero as well.

In particular, on every smaller original ball,

$$(-t)\,\|\partial_z v_\theta(t)\|_\infty \longrightarrow 0. \tag{12}$$

Otherwise select points and times where this fails and use the same finite-axis or receding-axis alternatives. At the selected point $\partial_Z S_n = \lambda_n^2 \partial_z v_\theta$ tends to zero. If its scaled radial coordinate tends to zero, the conclusion instead follows directly from $\partial_Z S_n(0, Z, s) = 0$ and the mixed second-derivative bound. This proves (12).

3.1 A necessary stress input on late time intervals

The same compactness argument also gives a requirement for sustaining a nonzero rescaled mean swirl, without assuming (3). It concerns the actual radial and axial fluxes of angular momentum.

Proposition 4. *Fix $0 < b < 1$, $\kappa > 0$, $0 < h < 1/2$, and constants $C, F_0 \geq 0$. Consider smooth divergence-free solutions on $B(1) \times (-1, 0)$ whose mean satisfies (1)–(2) with constant C, allowing an original force of supremum at most F_0. Let $e = \mathcal{P}(w_r w_\theta)$, $f = \mathcal{P}(w_z w_\theta)$ and define*

$$\mathcal{B}_\tau(T) = \tau^h \int_{-T\tau}^{-\tau} \left(\|e(t)\|_\infty + \tau^h \|f(t)\|_\infty \right) \mathrm{d}t.$$

There are $T > 1$, $\varepsilon > 0$, and $0 < \tau_0 < 1/T$, depending only on the listed constants, such that, for every such solution and $0 < \tau < \tau_0$,

$$\tau^{1/2+h} \|v_\theta(-\tau)\|_{L^\infty(B(b))} \geq \kappa \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \mathcal{B}_\tau(T) \geq \varepsilon. \tag{13}$$

The stress norms are over $B(1)$. Infinite integrals satisfy the conclusion automatically. No local energy or suitability hypothesis is needed for this swirl statement.

Proof. If no such constants existed, choose solutions and scales with $T_n = n$, $\tau_n < n^{-2}$, and $\mathcal{B}_{\tau_n}(n) < 1/n$, while the left side of (13) is at least κ. Choose spatial points realizing at least half this supremum. On every fixed rescaled time slab the Reynolds source in (10) then tends to zero in $L^1_t W^{-1,p}_x$ away from the scaled axis. The original force contributes at most $\lambda_n^3 \delta_n F_0$, which also vanishes. The uniform mean bounds give precisely the spatial compactness, time increment bounds, and weak-* drift limits used above.

If the selected radii divided by λ_n stay bounded, the limit is the ancient swirl of Lemma 3, hence zero. A selected scaled radius tending to zero is already excluded by $S_n(0, Z, s) = 0$ and the uniform radial derivative bound. If those radii tend to infinity, recenter there; the limiting bounded scalar equation is the receding-axis equation above, whose ancient solution is also zero. In either case convergence at $s = -1$ contradicts the selected value of size at least $\kappa/2$. The fixed distance of $B(b)$ from the boundary permits every compact rescaled spatial set in these limits. □

Since $|e|, |f| \leq K^2$, persistent nonzero rescaled mean swirl therefore requires, on every sufficiently late interval of this fixed ratio,

$$\int_{-T\tau}^{-\tau} K(t)^2 \, \mathrm{d}t \geq \frac{\varepsilon}{2} \tau^{-h}. \tag{14}$$

Its root-mean-square defect amplitude on that interval is at least a constant times $\tau^{-1/2-h/2}$. This is an interval estimate; it permits intermittency and gives no pointwise lower bound at every time.

The signed quantity preceding this norm estimate has a useful exact form. Write $\Gamma_n = RS_n$ and let ψ be a smooth test function with compact spatial support away from $R = 0$. Set

$$\mathcal{A}_n^* \psi = \psi_{RR} + \delta_n^2 \psi_{ZZ} + \partial_R((V_n + R^{-1})\psi) + \partial_Z(W_n \psi).$$

For $s_0 < s_1$, with spatial integrals in $\mathrm{d}R\,\mathrm{d}Z$, the circulation equation gives

$$\left[\int \Gamma_n \psi \right]_{s_0}^{s_1} - \int_{s_0}^{s_1} \int \Gamma_n (\psi_s + \mathcal{A}_n^* \psi) = \lambda_n^2 \delta_n \int_{s_0}^{s_1} \int \left[e_n (R\psi_R - \psi) + \delta_n f_n R \psi_Z \right]. \tag{15}$$

Here the original force is zero; otherwise its circulation work is added on the right. Both sides retain the signs of the actual stress. The identity follows by integrating $-R\partial_R e_n - 2e_n - \delta_n R \partial_Z f_n$ against ψ. For a backward adjoint solution the bulk mean term would cancel; (15) itself needs no such kernel construction. Neither this identity nor (14) estimates the recurrent work from initial data.

4 Meridional smallness

Define, on a smaller ball,

$$G_v(t) = \| |\partial_r v_r| + |v_r/r| + |\partial_z v_z| + |\partial_z v_r| \|_\infty .$$

We verify the two changes needed in the proof of [1, Proposition 1.5] to conclude

$$(-t) G_v(t) \longrightarrow 0. \tag{16}$$

First, the preceding swirl argument gives $S_n \to 0$ on compact rescaled time slabs. The mean bounds also give $|S_n/R| \le C$ on those slabs, including the axis. Splitting at $R = \epsilon$ shows that S_n^2/R^2 tends to zero locally in L^1 in the lifted space. In the receding-axis case the source is $\partial_Z(S_n^2/(A_n + R))$, which likewise tends to zero in distributions.

Second, the force is small in a negative Sobolev norm integrated in time, rather than uniformly small as a function. Away from the axis, (7) and (8) give

$$\|G_n\|_{L^1(J;W^{-2,p}(D))} \longrightarrow 0$$

for a fixed rectangle D and any finite p. The analogous assertion holds in the receding-axis case. The other terms in the rescaled vorticity equation are uniformly bounded in this negative norm. Together with the uniform spatial Lipschitz bound supplied by (1)–(2), this gives an increment bound $C|s - s'| + \epsilon_n$ with $\epsilon_n \to 0$. Interpolation gives asymptotic uniform time equicontinuity, also at the selected upper time. Finitely many initial members are smooth, so Arzelà–Ascoli still applies. Boundedness and the small volume of $R < \epsilon$ give convergence across the axis.

The remaining ancient-limit argument is unchanged: the force and swirl source vanish, and the mean bounds supply the backward decay and bounded Lipschitz drift required by [1, Lemma 3.3]. The limiting vorticity vanishes. At the selected time, incompressibility and boundedness of the limiting meridional velocity then contradict a nonzero selected derivative, in either axis case. This proves (16). No bound on $\partial_r v_z$ is asserted.

5 Full-velocity enstrophy

Choose a radial cutoff χ whose derivative is supported in a regular annulus, and write

$$Y = \|\chi \operatorname{curl} u\|_2^2 , \quad M = \|\chi \nabla \operatorname{curl} u\|_2^2 , \quad A_v = \|\partial_z v_\theta\|_\infty .$$

Here A_v and G_v are taken on a ball containing the support of χ, with its boundary in the regular annulus; K is still taken on $B(1)$. All cutoff errors are uniformly bounded. Weighted L^2 contraction of angular averaging, including its tensor action on gradients, gives $Y_v \le Y$ and $M_v \le M$. Local div–curl estimates consequently bound the first derivatives of u, v by $C(Y+1)^{1/2}$ and their second derivatives by $C(M+1)^{1/2}$ in these weighted norms.

For $\Pi_\chi(q) = \int \chi^2 (\operatorname{curl} q \cdot \nabla) q \cdot \operatorname{curl} q$, put $\omega_q = \operatorname{curl} q$. There is an exact telescoping identity

$$\begin{aligned} \Pi_\chi(u) - \Pi_\chi(v) = \int \chi^2 \big[&(\omega_w \cdot \nabla) u \cdot \omega_u + (\omega_v \cdot \nabla) w \cdot \omega_u \\ &+ (\omega_v \cdot \nabla) v \cdot \omega_w \big]. \end{aligned} \tag{17}$$

Integrate the derivative on w off that factor in each term. The remaining factors have derivative orders one and two, apart from bounded cutoff errors. Hence, for every $\epsilon > 0$,

$$\begin{aligned} |\Pi_\chi(u) - \Pi_\chi(v)| &\le CK(Y+1)^{1/2}(M+1)^{1/2} + C \\ &\le \epsilon M + C_\epsilon (K^2+1)(Y+1). \end{aligned}$$

For the mean's stretching, write $a = (\omega_v)_r = -\partial_z v_\theta$, $b = (\omega_v)_\theta = \partial_z v_r - \partial_r v_z$, and $c = (\omega_v)_z = \partial_r v_\theta + v_\theta/r$. The cylindrical gradient identity underlying [1, Equation (5.7)] can be rewritten exactly as

$$(\omega_v \cdot \nabla) v \cdot \omega_v = a^2 \partial_r v_r + b^2 v_r/r + c^2 \partial_z v_z + 2ac\partial_z v_r - abc - 2ab\, v_\theta/r. \tag{18}$$

In particular the large derivative $\partial_r v_z$ has been replaced using the vorticity relation, and the last two terms have the coefficient a, whose supremum is A_v.

A local radial integration by parts gives

$$\|\chi v_\theta/r\|_2^2 \le \|\chi(\omega_v)_z\|_2^2 + C. \tag{19}$$

Indeed, after expanding $(\partial_r v_\theta + v_\theta/r)^2 r$, its cross term is $\partial_r(v_\theta^2)$. The axis boundary term vanishes because $v_\theta = O(r)$; the cutoff error is $2\int \chi \partial_r \chi\, v_\theta^2 \,\mathrm{d}r\,\mathrm{d}z\,\mathrm{d}\theta$. It is bounded on the regular annulus, including its intersection with the axis, where $\partial_r \chi/r$ is bounded. Applying Cauchy–Schwarz to the last two terms of (18), and using (19), yields

$$\Pi_\chi(v) \le C(G_v + A_v)(Y_v + 1).$$

Testing the original unforced vorticity equation and absorbing the small dissipation term from the full-velocity difference now gives

$$Y' + cM \le C_*[G_v + A_v + K^2 + 1](Y + 1). \tag{20}$$

Fix $\eta > 0$. Equations (16) and (12) allow a final interval on which $G_v + A_v \le \eta/\tau$. Since $K \in L_t^2$, Gronwall in (20) gives

$$Y(t) + 1 \le C_\eta(-t)^{-C_*\eta}.$$

Here C_* was fixed before η. Choose η with $2C_*\eta < 1$. Local Sobolev now places u in $L_t^4 L_x^6$ on a smaller cylinder. The local criterion of [2, Theorem 1.1(i)], applied on backward cylinders ending at zero, makes $(0,0)$ regular. This finishes the proof of Theorem 1.

6 A separate quantitative gradient-history estimate

Regularity in Theorem 1 requires only (3). For applications which additionally require an absolute gradient or torque history, the actual defect equation gives the following stronger estimate. The whole-space assumptions here control the pressure produced by localization; they are not assumptions of Theorem 1.

Theorem 5. *Let u be a smooth unforced solution on $\mathbb{R}^3 \times (-1,0)$ with $u \in L^\infty((-1,0); L^2(\mathbb{R}^3))$ and canonical pressure, whose restriction to Q satisfies the local suitability assumptions above. For some $0 < h < 1/2$, assume only the following mean bounds on $B(1)$:*

$$\|v(-\tau)\|_\infty \le C_M \tau^{-1/2-h}, \qquad \|\nabla v(-\tau)\|_\infty \le C_N \tau^{-1-h}, \tag{21}$$

with Cartesian derivatives. Suppose, for some $0 < a < 1$,

$$\int_0^a \tau^{-h/2}\sqrt{\log(e/\tau)}\, \|w(-\tau)\|_{L^\infty(B(1))}^2 \,\mathrm{d}\tau < \infty. \tag{22}$$

Then, on a smaller ball and final time interval,

$$\int \sqrt{-t}\, \|w(t)\|_\infty \|\nabla w(t)\|_\infty \,\mathrm{d}t < \infty. \tag{23}$$

It also bounds the same weighted integral of $\|(\mathcal{P}[(w\cdot\nabla)w])_\theta\|_\infty$. *For this additional conclusion, the amplitude power* $\|w(-\tau)\|_\infty \le C\tau^{-\beta}$ *suffices when* $\beta < 1/2 - h/4$. *At equality, a factor* $\log(e/\tau)^{-p}$ *suffices for* $p > 3/4$. *If the full mean geometry of Theorem 1 also holds, regularity already follows from the weaker condition (3).*

The theorem does not assert (22) from initial data. Its proof has a whole-space smoothing estimate and a localization step. On a sufficiently short final interval it bounds (23) by a constant times the integral in (22), plus a bounded annular-source contribution. Write $\mathbb{L}$ for the Leray projection, to distinguish it from angular averaging $\mathcal{P}$.

Lemma 6. *Let a smooth divergence-free* U *on* $\mathbb{R}^3 \times [0,d]$ *satisfy*

$$U_t - \Delta U = -\mathbb{L}\,\mathrm{div}(U\otimes U) + g, \qquad V = \mathcal{P}U, \quad W = U - V, \quad G = (1-\mathcal{P})g.$$

Assume the fields and the spatial derivatives used below are bounded on compact time prefixes, and that $\|V\|_\infty \le M$, $\|\nabla V\|_\infty \le N$, $\|G\|_\infty \le G_0$ *there, with* $M, N > 0$. *Put* $K(q) = \|W(q)\|_\infty$, $L(q) = \|\nabla W(q)\|_\infty$, *and*

$$Z_d = \sup_{0<q\le d}\{K(q) + \sqrt{q}L(q)\}, \qquad \log_+ x = \max(\log x, 0).$$

There are universal constants such that

$$Z_d \le C_0(K(0) + dG_0) + C_1 N d\left[1 + \log_+ \frac{M}{N\sqrt{d}}\right] Z_d + C_2\sqrt{d}Z_d^2. \tag{24}$$

Consequently $Z_d \le 2C_0(K(0)+dG_0)$ *if the linear coefficient is at most* $1/4$ *and* $\sqrt{d}(K(0)+dG_0)$ *is sufficiently small.*

Proof. Rotation covariance gives the exact homogeneous-in-W equation

$$W_t - \Delta W = -\mathbb{L}\,\mathrm{div}\left[V\otimes W + W\otimes V + (1-\mathcal{P})(W\otimes W)\right] + G. \tag{25}$$

In particular the complete defect self-interaction is retained. For the heat kernel H_s, the kernel of $e^{s\Delta}\mathbb{L}\,\mathrm{div}$ is

$$(B_s)_{ijk} = \delta_{ij}\partial_k H_s + \int_s^\infty \partial_{ijk} H_b \,\mathrm{d}b.$$

Differentiating the Gaussian and integrating in b gives

$$|B_s(y)| \le C(\sqrt{s}+|y|)^{-4}, \qquad |\nabla B_s(y)| \le C(\sqrt{s}+|y|)^{-5},$$
$$\|B_s\|_1 \le Cs^{-1/2}, \qquad \int |y|\,|\nabla B_s(y)|\,\mathrm{d}y \le Cs^{-1/2}.$$

The first absolute moment of B_s is not integrable at infinity. Splitting the radial integral at $\sqrt{s}$ and M/N instead gives

$$\int |B_s(y)|\min(N|y|, 2M)\,\mathrm{d}y \le CN\left[1 + \log_+\frac{M}{N\sqrt{s}}\right], \tag{26}$$

$$\int |\nabla B_s(y)|\min(N|y|, 2M)\,\mathrm{d}y \le CNs^{-1/2}. \tag{27}$$

For each endpoint (x,q) follow the backward characteristic $z'(s) = V(z(s),s)$, $z(q) = x$, and set $a(s) = V(z(s),s)$. Move $a(s)\cdot\nabla W$ to the left side of (25); its two linear tensors now contain $V - a$

instead of V, since $\operatorname{div} W = 0$. This identity holds everywhere with this one spatially constant $a(s)$. The translated Duhamel kernels at the chosen endpoint are centered at $z(s)$, where

$$|V(y,s) - a(s)| \le \min(N|y - z(s)|, 2M).$$

For the gradient estimate, differentiate that representation with $a(s)$ held fixed. No derivative of the selected characteristic is introduced: the same representation is valid at every nearby endpoint with this fixed a. Estimates (26)–(27) bound the linear amplitude and gradient terms.

For the quadratic gradient term move the derivative onto the tensor: $\|\nabla(1-\mathcal{P})(W\otimes W)\|_\infty \le CKL$. Angular averaging and its tensor action are contractions in the Euclidean sup norms. The time integral $\int_0^q (q-s)^{-1/2} s^{-1/2}\,\mathrm{d}s = \pi$ then bounds this term by CZ_d^2, before multiplication by $\sqrt{q}$. The quadratic amplitude term is bounded by $C\sqrt{q}Z_d^2$. The initial term and the divergence-free source use the ordinary translated heat kernel. Finally

$$\int_0^q \left[1 + \log_+ \frac{M}{N\sqrt{s}}\right] \mathrm{d}s \le Cq \left[1 + \log_+ \frac{M}{N\sqrt{q}}\right].$$

This proves (24). The estimate holds on every shorter prefix, whose linear coefficient is no larger. A continuity bootstrap gives the final claim; smoothness supplies the initial continuity. If $K(0) + dG_0 = 0$, use uniqueness or a positive bootstrap bound tending to zero. □

Proof of Theorem 5. First suppose a globally bounded defect equation as in Lemma 6 has been obtained, with G uniformly bounded and

$$\|V(-\tau)\|_\infty \le C_M \tau^{-1/2-h}, \qquad \|\nabla V(-\tau)\|_\infty \le C_N \tau^{-1-h}. \tag{28}$$

Let $\ell(\tau) = \log(e/\tau)$ and choose

$$d(\tau) = \frac{c\tau^{1+h}}{\ell(\tau)}, \qquad 0 < c < 1. \tag{29}$$

On $[-\tau - d, -\tau]$, the linear coefficient in (24) is at most $Cc(1 + |\log c| + h)$: here $Nd \le C_N c/\ell$ and $M/(N\sqrt{d})$ is bounded by a constant times $c^{-1/2}\tau^{-h/2}\sqrt{\ell}$. Take c small enough in terms of the mean bounds.

Write $K = \|W\|_\infty$, $L = \|\nabla W\|_\infty$, and

$$E(\tau) = \int_\tau^{\tau + d(\tau)} K(-s)^2\,\mathrm{d}s.$$

Condition (22), with the localized global norm, implies $K \in L_t^2$ and $E(\tau) \to 0$. There is a time $s_0 \in [-\tau - d, -\tau - d/2]$ at which $K(s_0)^2 \le 2E(\tau)/d$. Applying Lemma 6 on $[s_0, -\tau]$ is therefore legitimate for all sufficiently small τ; its small parameter is at most $C\sqrt{E(\tau)} + d^{3/2}G_0 \to 0$. We obtain

$$K(-\tau) + \sqrt{d}L(-\tau) \le C[d^{-1/2}\sqrt{E(\tau)} + dG_0]. \tag{30}$$

Consequently

$$\sqrt{\tau}K(-\tau)L(-\tau) \le C\sqrt{\tau}d^{-3/2}E(\tau) + C\sqrt{\tau}d^{3/2}G_0^2. \tag{31}$$

The second term is integrable. For the first, Tonelli gives

$$\int_0^{a/2} \sqrt{\tau} d(\tau)^{-3/2} E(\tau)\,\mathrm{d}\tau \le C \int_0^a s^{-h/2}\sqrt{\ell(s)}K(-s)^2\,\mathrm{d}s. \tag{32}$$

Indeed, $\tau \le s \le \tau + d(\tau)$ implies $s/(1+c) \le \tau \le s$. Since d increases, these τ lie in an interval of length at most $d(s)$, while the integrand's coefficient is at most $Cs^{-1-3h/2}\ell(s)^{3/2}$. This proves (32), hence the gradient history on a final interval. The angularly averaged torque is at most KL.

It remains to construct the localization used above. Choose a radial cutoff χ, equal to one on an interior ball and with its transition inside a regular annulus of the original solution. Put

$$\Psi = (-\Delta)^{-1} \operatorname{curl} u, \qquad U = \operatorname{curl}(\chi\Psi) = \chi u + b, \qquad b = \nabla\chi \times \Psi.$$

The L^2 hypothesis and incompressibility give $\operatorname{curl}\Psi = u$; the potential is well defined by its order-minus-one kernel. On the annulus, its separated kernel and every required derivative are bounded against $\|u\|_2$, while its local part is controlled by interior spatial regularity. For canonical pressure, the same decomposition for its order-zero transform of $u \otimes u$ bounds p and its spatial derivatives on the annulus. Likewise

$$\Psi_t = -\operatorname{curl} u - (-\Delta)^{-1} \operatorname{curl}\operatorname{div}(u \otimes u)$$

has bounded spatial derivatives there: its bilinear operator is of order zero, with separated kernels controlled by $\|u\|_2^2$. These statements use only annular regularity and the uniform energy bound, not regularity of the interior through time zero.

With pressure χp, the exact force of U is

$$\begin{aligned} f_U = b_t - 2\nabla\chi\cdot\nabla u - (\Delta\chi)u - \Delta b + p\nabla\chi \\ + (U\cdot\nabla)U - \chi(u\cdot\nabla)u. \end{aligned} \tag{33}$$

It is supported in the regular annulus and uniformly bounded in spatial C^1. Its Leray projection is uniformly bounded, as follows by subtracting $f_U(x)$ in the local principal value and using its L^1 norm for the far part. Thus the equation for U has $g = \mathbb{L}f_U$ and bounded $G = (1-\mathcal{P})g$, including pressure.

Rotations preserve the interior ball, so $U = u$, $\mathcal{P}U = v$, and $U - \mathcal{P}U = w$ there. The transition region contributes bounded fields and derivatives; outside the cutoff $U = 0$. The mean assumptions therefore imply (28) globally. The global weighted amplitude integral is bounded by (22) plus the finite contribution of a bounded function. Equations (30)–(32) now supply (23) on a smaller cylinder of the original flow. The power and logarithmic consequences follow by integrating $\tau^{-h/2-2\beta}\ell(\tau)^{1/2-2p}$. □

7 The sign of kinetic mean–defect transfer

For a smooth finite-energy whole-space unforced flow, orthogonality of angular averaging and integration by parts give

$$\frac{1}{2}\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\|w\|_2^2 + \nu\|\nabla w\|_2^2 = -T, \qquad \frac{1}{2}\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\|v\|_2^2 + \nu\|\nabla v\|_2^2 = T, \quad T = \int w\cdot(w\cdot\nabla)v. \tag{34}$$

We display viscosity explicitly in this section. Defect self-advection and pressure do no kinetic work on w; the averaging correction is orthogonal to w. In particular the signed net kinetic transfer obeys

$$-\int_0^t T(s)\,\mathrm{d}s = \tfrac{1}{2}\|v(0)\|_2^2 - \tfrac{1}{2}\|v(t)\|_2^2 - \nu\int_0^t \|\nabla v\|_2^2\,\mathrm{d}s \le \tfrac{1}{2}\|v(0)\|_2^2 .$$

This does not bound its positive variation or the critical amplitude integral (3). The following example also excludes an automatic viscous damping argument based just on small relative angular defect.

Proposition 7. *For every $\nu > 0$, $C > 0$, and $0 < \epsilon \le 1$, there are real Schwartz solenoidal data u_+ and u_- with $\|u_\pm\|_2 = 1$ and the same angular mean v. Their defects $w_\pm = u_\pm - v$ have equal squared L^2 and gradient norms, and $\|w_\pm\|_2 = (3\epsilon/2)\,\|v\|_2$. Their nonlinear kinetic transfers have opposite signs, and the unforced solution from u_+ satisfies at its initial time*

$$\frac{1}{2}\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\,\|w_+(t)\|_2^2 > C\nu\,\|\nabla w_+\|_2^2\,.$$

The mean satisfies the spatial bounds (1)–(2) at a time $t = -\tau_\lambda$, with $h = 1/6$ and a constant independent of the concentration parameter λ and of $\epsilon \in (0, 1]$. This last assertion concerns that time slice, not an entire evolution.

Proof. Set $\rho = x^2 + y^2 + z^2$, $r^2 = x^2 + y^2$, and, for $\sigma = \pm 1$,

$$V = \operatorname{curl}(e^{-\rho} e_z), \qquad W_\sigma = \operatorname{curl}\left((x^2 - y^2 + 2\sigma x y r^2) e^{-\rho} e_z\right).$$

Both fields are horizontal, divergence free and Schwartz; $\mathcal{P}V = V$ and $\mathcal{P}W_\sigma = 0$. Write $g_a = (\pi/a)^{3/2}$. Gaussian moments give

$$\begin{aligned} \|V\|_2^2 &= 2g_2, & \|W_\sigma\|_2^2 &= \tfrac{9}{2} g_2, \\ \|\nabla_h W_\sigma\|_2^2 &= 30 g_2, & \|\partial_z W_\sigma\|_2^2 &= \tfrac{9}{2} g_2, \\ \int W_\sigma \cdot (W_\sigma \cdot \nabla) V &= -\sigma \tfrac{16}{9} g_3. \end{aligned}$$

For example, the radial–azimuthal entry of $\mathcal{P}(W_\sigma \otimes W_\sigma)$ is $2\sigma r^4 e^{-2\rho}$, while $\partial_r V_\theta - V_\theta / r = -4 r^2 e^{-\rho}$; their product directly gives the last integral.

Let $\mu = \lambda^{2/3}$, $\lambda \ge 1$, and put

$$C_\epsilon = g_2(2 + \tfrac{9}{2}\epsilon^2), \qquad A = \frac{\lambda\sqrt{\mu}}{\sqrt{C_\epsilon}}, \qquad u_\sigma(x, y, z) = A(V + \epsilon W_\sigma)(\lambda x, \lambda y, \mu z).$$

The absence of an axial component preserves incompressibility under this anisotropic scaling. Orthogonality proves the stated unit norm and relative defect norm. The positive nonlinear injection $I_+ = -T_+$ and its viscous cost νD_+ obey

$$\frac{I_+}{\nu D_+} = \frac{A\lambda(16 g_3/9)}{\nu g_2(30\lambda^2 + \frac{9}{2}\mu^2)} \longrightarrow \infty.$$

Indeed this ratio grows as a positive constant times $\lambda^{1/3}/\nu$, with ϵ fixed. Choose it larger than $C + 1$ and apply (34). For $\sigma = -1$ the injection changes sign while the dissipation is unchanged. These are jets of actual local unforced solutions from Schwartz data; no imposed strain or truncated source is used. Continuity also gives a nonzero initial interval with the strict inequality, but no uniform length of that interval is asserted.

Finally take $\tau_\lambda = \lambda^{-2}$. The mean has only an azimuthal component, whose (a, b) derivative is bounded by

$$C_{ab}\lambda^{4/3 + a + (2/3)b} = C_{ab}\tau_\lambda^{-1/2 - 1/6 - a/2 - (1/2 - 1/6)b}.$$

The constants are uniform for $0 < \epsilon \le 1$ because $C_\epsilon \ge 2g_2$. This proves the asserted spatial bounds. □

The example refutes zero-allowance viscous absorption of kinetic mean–defect transfer, even with small relative defect and the stated spatial geometry. It does not refute a data-dependent history allowance, control of repeated interactions, or Theorems 1 and 5. In particular these transfers are kinetic energy transfers, not vorticity stretching integrals.

There is also an exact circulation test. The initial mean circulation $\Gamma = rv_\theta$ has its global maximum at $r = 1/\lambda$, $z = 0$, with value $2A/(e\lambda)$. For the base Gaussian defect,

$$rF_\theta = 4\sigma r^4(2r^2 - 3)e^{-2\rho}, \qquad F = -\mathcal{P}[(W_\sigma \cdot \nabla)W_\sigma].$$

At that maximum the radial and axial diffusion of the base circulation are $-8/e$ and $-4/e$. Consequently the actual initial mean equation gives

$$\Gamma_t(1/\lambda, 0) = -\frac{4\nu A}{e\lambda}(2\lambda^2 + \mu^2) - \frac{4\sigma\epsilon^2 A^2}{e^2}. \tag{35}$$

For $\sigma = -1$, choose λ still larger so that $\epsilon^2 A/(\nu\lambda) > e[2 + (\mu/\lambda)^2]$. The value at the old maximum then increases initially, and hence exceeds the initial global maximum. Its energy comes from the defect in (34). Thus the maximum principle for exactly axisymmetric circulation cannot be extended by dropping the Reynolds torque, even for arbitrarily small relative angular defect. This is an initial growth example, not repeated spin-up or singularity formation.

Proposition 8. *There are constants $c_0, c_1, c_2, C_0 > 0$ with the following property. Fix $\nu > 0$, $0 < \epsilon \le 1$, and $0 < h \le 1/6$. Set*

$$\mu = \lambda^{1-2h}, \qquad A = \lambda^{1+2h}/\sqrt{C_\epsilon}, \qquad u_\lambda(x_h, z) = A(V + \epsilon W_-)(\lambda x_h, \mu z).$$

For every sufficiently large λ, the actual unforced solution from u_λ exists at least until

$$t_\lambda = \frac{c_0}{A\lambda}.$$

These data have $\|u_\lambda\|_2^2 = \lambda^{-1+6h} \le 1$ and relative L^2 defect $3\epsilon/2$. For $h = 1/6$ they are the unit-energy data u_- of Proposition 7. Its mean circulation has a smooth branch of local maxima in the meridional variables, at $(r, z) = (r_\lambda(t), 0)$, starting at $(\lambda^{-1}, 0)$. Along this branch the radius strictly decreases and the circulation strictly increases. At the last time,

$$r_\lambda(t_\lambda) \le \lambda^{-1}(1 - c_1\epsilon^2), \tag{36}$$

$$\Gamma(r_\lambda(t_\lambda), 0, t_\lambda) \ge \frac{2A}{e\lambda}(1 + c_1\epsilon^2). \tag{37}$$

On this whole interval the mean satisfies (1)–(2) with this h, constant C_0, and $\tau = \lambda^{-2} - t > 0$. Furthermore

$$\int_0^{t_\lambda} \|u(t) - \mathcal{P}u(t)\|^2_{L^\infty(B(1))}\, \mathrm{d}t \ge c_2\epsilon^2\lambda^{2h}. \tag{38}$$

All constants are independent of $\nu, \epsilon, h, \lambda$; the required lower threshold on λ may depend on ν, ϵ, h. The number λ^{-2} specifies a comparison scale, not an asserted singular time.

Proof. Put $y_h = \lambda x_h$, $Z = \mu z$, $s = A\lambda t$, $U = u/A$, and

$$\delta = \mu/\lambda = \lambda^{-2h}, \qquad \eta = \nu\lambda/A, \qquad D_\delta = (\partial_{y_1}, \partial_{y_2}, \delta\partial_Z), \qquad \Delta_\delta = \partial_{y_1y_1} + \partial_{y_2y_2} + \delta^2\partial_{ZZ}.$$

The full projected equation, including pressure, is

$$U_s = -\mathbb{P}_\delta[(U \cdot D_\delta)U] + \eta\Delta_\delta U, \qquad D_\delta \cdot U = 0, \tag{39}$$

with initial field $V + \epsilon W_-$. Here $\mathbb{P}_\delta$ has Fourier multiplier $I - k_\delta \otimes k_\delta/|k_\delta|^2$, $k_\delta = (k_1, k_2, \delta k_3)$. It is an orthogonal projection of norm at most one in every isotropic Sobolev space and commutes with derivatives. No estimate of an inverse power of δ is used.

For $0 < \delta \le 1$ and $0 \le \eta \le 1$, differentiated energy estimates for (39) give

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}s} \|U\|_{H^{10}}^2 \le C \|U\|_{H^{10}}^3 .$$

Indeed the leading transport cancels by $D_\delta \cdot U = 0$, the commutators have the usual Sobolev product bounds with $|k_\delta| \le |k|$, and the diffusion is nonpositive in the energy. Friedrichs regularization, this estimate, and the corresponding difference estimate construct a common interval $[0, s_0]$ with $\|U\|_{H^{10}} \le M$, uniformly in these parameters and $0 < \epsilon \le 1$. The initial norm is bounded by $\|V\|_{H^{10}} + \|W_-\|_{H^{10}}$. Higher derivative estimates propagate smoothness on that interval. The equation also bounds U_s in H^8 and, after one time derivative, U_{ss} in H^6, uniformly. Sobolev embedding therefore gives uniform spatial bounds for the needed time derivatives.

The fluctuation $w^* = U - \mathcal{P}U$ satisfies the exact equation

$$w_s^* = -\mathbb{P}_\delta\big[(v^* \cdot D_\delta)w^* + (w^* \cdot D_\delta)v^* + (1 - \mathcal{P})((w^* \cdot D_\delta)w^*)\big] + \eta \Delta_\delta w^*, \qquad v^* = \mathcal{P}U. \tag{40}$$

Angular averaging is an orthogonal projection in isotropic H^8, commutes with the isotropic Sobolev multiplier and with $\mathbb{P}_\delta$, and annihilates w^*. Thus the mean correction in the quadratic term does no H^8 work on w^*. Transport cancellation and product bounds, using the uniform H^{10} bound on U, give

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}s} \|w^*\|_{H^8}^2 \le C_M \|w^*\|_{H^8}^2 , \qquad \|w^*\|_{H^8} + \|w_s^*\|_{H^6} \le C\epsilon \quad (0 \le s \le s_0).$$

The time-derivative estimate follows directly from (40). In particular the stress $\mathcal{P}(w^* \otimes w^*)$ and its time derivative have spatial C^3 norm at most $C\epsilon^2$ on any fixed annulus.

Let $\widetilde{\Gamma} = R(\mathcal{P}U)_\theta$, where $R = |y_h|$. Initially $\widetilde{\Gamma} = 2R^2 e^{-R^2 - Z^2}$. At $(1, 0)$ its meridional Hessian is diagonal with entries $-8/e$ and $-4/e$. The actual mean equation and the Gaussian torque above give exactly

$$\begin{aligned} \widetilde{\Gamma}_s(1, 0, 0) &= 4\epsilon^2/e^2 - 4\eta(2 + \delta^2)/e, \\ \widetilde{\Gamma}_{sR}(1, 0, 0) &= -16\epsilon^2/e^2 + 16\eta/e. \end{aligned}$$

Reflection in Z, with the axial velocity component reflected too, is a symmetry of (39) and its initial data. Uniqueness keeps $\widetilde{\Gamma}$ even in Z. The implicit function theorem and the uniform derivative bounds therefore give a uniform short interval with a nearby meridional local maximum at $(R_*(s), 0)$, $R_*(0) = 1$. Its Hessian remains negative definite, with $|\widetilde{\Gamma}_{RR}| \le 12/e$ there.

Axisymmetry and the mean's actual divergence constraint give

$$v_r^*(R, Z) = -\frac{\delta}{R} \int_0^R q \partial_Z v_z^*(q, Z) \, \mathrm{d}q.$$

Cauchy–Schwarz and the H_Z^1 trace bound into $L_{y_h}^2$ bound this by $C\delta$ uniformly in space. With $f = \partial_Z v_z^*$ its first two radial derivatives are

$$\partial_R v_r^* = -\delta f(R) + \delta \int_0^1 q f(qR) \, \mathrm{d}q, \qquad \partial_{RR} v_r^* = -\delta f_R(R) + \delta \int_0^1 q^2 f_R(qR) \, \mathrm{d}q.$$

The same estimates after axial derivatives and the uniform Sobolev bounds give $|\partial_R^a \partial_Z^b v_r^*| \le C\delta$ for $a + b \le 2$. The other two components have uniformly bounded cylindrical derivatives of these

orders. Applying the same argument to v_s^*, bounded in H^8, also gives an $O(\delta)$ bound on the first two derivatives of $v_{r,s}^*$.

On the fixed rectangle about $(1,0)$, the mean circulation equation is

$$\widetilde{\Gamma}_s + v_r^*\widetilde{\Gamma}_R + \delta v_z^*\widetilde{\Gamma}_Z = \eta(\widetilde{\Gamma}_{RR} - R^{-1}\widetilde{\Gamma}_R + \delta^2\widetilde{\Gamma}_{ZZ}) - Re_R - 2e - \delta R f_Z,$$

where $e = \mathcal{P}(w_r^* w_\theta^*)$ and $f = \mathcal{P}(w_z^* w_\theta^*)$. The preceding bounds, and then one time derivative of this equation, give

$$\left\|\widetilde{\Gamma}_s\right\|_{C^2} + \left\|\widetilde{\Gamma}_{ss}\right\|_{C^1} \le C(\delta + \eta + \epsilon^2).$$

For the diffusive term after that derivative, the uniform H^8 bound on U_s supplies the required derivatives of $\widetilde{\Gamma}_s$. Hence, if λ is large enough that $\delta + \eta \le \epsilon^2/(12e)$, the two displayed initial rates, evaluated along the maximum branch, change by at most $C\epsilon^2 s$. After reducing a universal $c_0 > 0$, for every $0 \le s \le c_0$,

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}s}\widetilde{\Gamma}(R_*(s), 0, s) \ge 2\epsilon^2/e^2, \qquad R_*'(s) = -\frac{\widetilde{\Gamma}_{sR}}{\widetilde{\Gamma}_{RR}} \le -\frac{2\epsilon^2}{3e}.$$

Integrating and using $r_\lambda = R_*/\lambda$ and $\Gamma = (A/\lambda)\widetilde{\Gamma}$ proves (36)–(37) for some universal $c_1 > 0$. The branch starts at the global circulation maximum and its value exceeds that initial maximum. It need not be identified with the global maximizer at later times.

For the stated physical mean geometry, the radial estimates and $A\delta = \lambda/\sqrt{C_\epsilon}$ give exactly the claimed mean bounds at scale $\tau_\lambda = \lambda^{-2}$. For large λ, $t_\lambda < \tau_\lambda/2$; using $\tau_\lambda - t$ only enlarges their right-hand sides.

Finally $W_-(1,0,0) = (-2/e, 0, 0)$ and the bound on w_s^* gives

$$\|U(s) - \mathcal{P}U(s) - \epsilon W_-\|_\infty \le C\epsilon s.$$

Reduce c_0 once more so that the defect at this fixed point has magnitude at least ϵ/e throughout the interval. Its physical point $(\lambda^{-1}, 0, 0)$ belongs to $B(1)$. Consequently the integral in (38) is at least

$$\frac{A^2\epsilon^2}{e^2}\,\frac{c_0}{A\lambda} = \frac{c_0\epsilon^2}{e^2\sqrt{C_\epsilon}}\lambda^{2h}.$$

The uniform upper bound on C_ϵ proves the assertion. □

This is a finite concentrating event in the actual unforced equation, with all nonlinear feedback retained. It excludes a rule that such feedback always prevents inward motion and growth of a mean circulation peak. It also excludes a bound on the critical defect history depending only on kinetic energy, viscosity and an upper bound for the length of the smooth interval: the interval here tends to zero, whereas (38) tends to infinity for fixed ϵ. The initial higher norms grow with λ. No infinite cascade from one fixed datum, data-dependent history obstruction, or singularity follows from this family.

7.1 Fast axial seeds and the mean geometry

The preceding example has slow axial variation in both its mean and its defect. Fast axial oscillations need not remove its finite inward growth. Their phase relation matters, however, for the regularity of the angular mean. In cylindrical coordinates write

$$\Psi_\alpha(R, \phi, Z) = e^{-R^2 - Z^2}\left[R^2\cos(2\phi + \alpha) - R^4\sin(2\phi + \alpha)\right], \qquad W_\alpha = \mathrm{curl}_h(\Psi_\alpha e_z).$$

Here curl_h takes only the two horizontal derivatives and has zero axial component. These expressions extend smoothly across $R = 0$; $W_0 = W_-$. Two defects with a phase variable α are

$$W^{\mathrm{st}}(y_h, Z, \alpha) = W_0(y_h, Z)\cos\alpha, \qquad W^{\mathrm{hel}}(y_h, Z, \alpha) = W_\alpha(y_h, Z).$$

The first is a standing axial wave, while the second rotates its horizontal pattern with its axial phase.

Proposition 9. *Fix $\nu > 0$, $0 < \epsilon \le 1$, and $0 < h \le 1/6$. With $\delta = \lambda^{-2h}$, $\mu = \lambda^{1-2h}$ and $A = \lambda^{1+2h}/\sqrt{C_\epsilon}$ as in Proposition 8, set*

$$u^j_\lambda(x_h, z) = A\big[V(\lambda x_h, \mu z) + \epsilon W^j(\lambda x_h, \mu z, \lambda z)\big], \qquad j \in \{\mathrm{st}, \mathrm{hel}\}.$$

Both are real Schwartz solenoidal data, with the same angular mean, squared energy at most one and relative L^2 defect at most $3\epsilon/2$. Their initial means obey (1)–(2) with $\tau = \lambda^{-2}$ and a constant independent of λ and ϵ.

For all sufficiently large λ, the helical data have all the conclusions of Proposition 8, with universal constants, except that the maximum branch may also move axially: it is $(r_\lambda(t), z_\lambda(t))$, initially $(\lambda^{-1}, 0)$. In particular the mean geometry persists on $0 \le t \le c_0/(A\lambda)$, the branch moves inward and gains circulation by relative amounts at least $c_1\epsilon^2$, and its actual defect history is at least $c_2\epsilon^2\lambda^{2h}$. Its squared energy is exactly one when $h = 1/6$.

For the standing data, there instead exist universal $c_3, c_4 > 0$ such that, at $t_* = c_3\epsilon^2/(A\lambda)$ and $\tau_* = \lambda^{-2} - t_* > 0$, the actual unforced solution satisfies

$$\tau_*^{3/2-h}\left|\partial_{zz}(\mathcal{P}u^{\mathrm{st}}_\lambda)_\theta(\lambda^{-1}, 0, t_*)\right| \ge c_4\epsilon^4\lambda^{4h}. \tag{41}$$

Thus initial mean geometry, a bounded kinetic energy and a small relative defect alone do not propagate these mean bounds with a uniform constant. All thresholds on λ may depend on ν, ϵ, h.

Proof. Introduce an independent periodic variable $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}/(2\pi\mathbb{Z})$ and solve on $\mathbb{R}^2 \times \mathbb{R} \times (\mathbb{R}/(2\pi\mathbb{Z}))$ with

$$D_{\delta,*} = (\partial_1, \partial_2, \delta\partial_Z + \partial_\alpha), \qquad \eta = \nu\lambda/A,$$
$$U_s = -\mathbb{P}_{\delta,*}[(U \cdot D_{\delta,*})U] + \eta\Delta_{\delta,*}U, \qquad D_{\delta,*} \cdot U = 0, \quad U(0) = V + \epsilon W^j.$$

The projection has symbol $I - \kappa \otimes \kappa/|\kappa|^2$, where $\kappa = (k_1, k_2, \delta k_Z + n)$ and $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ is the phase frequency. It has norm at most one in every Sobolev space. The four-dimensional transport field $(U_1, U_2, \delta U_3, U_3)$ is divergence free. Thus the same transport cancellation, commutator estimates and nonpositive diffusion as before give a common smooth interval with a uniform H^{12} bound, for $0 < \delta \le 1$, $0 \le \eta \le 1$, and $0 < \epsilon \le 1$. The first three time derivatives are bounded in H^{10}, H^8, H^6, respectively. These estimates use the full phase derivative, not a truncation of the generated modes.

Restrict this solution to $\alpha = Z/\delta$. The restricted axial derivative $\delta\partial_Z$ is exactly $\delta\partial_Z + \partial_\alpha$ before restriction. Hence the restriction solves the actual three-dimensional projected equation, with its pressure, from the stated initial datum. The elementary H^1 bound in the periodic variable controls this restriction in $L^2_{y_h,Z}$; applying it to derivatives gives smoothness and finite Sobolev norms for each fixed $\delta > 0$. The pressure has the same property, so this is the finite-energy unforced evolution, by uniqueness. Rescaling $y_h = \lambda x_h$, $Z = \mu z$, and $s = A\lambda t$ gives the physical flow. In particular its phase is λz.

For the helical field the extended initial datum obeys the joint symmetry

$$U(R_\beta y_h, Z, \alpha - 2\beta) = R_\beta U(y_h, Z, \alpha),$$

where the rotation fixes the third velocity component. The equation commutes with this action, so uniqueness preserves it. Angular averaging therefore makes $v^* = \mathcal{P}U$ independent of α throughout the interval. This is a nonlinear symmetry assertion, not only a cancellation of the initial quadratic source. Consequently the physical mean's axial derivatives involve only its slow Z derivatives, which are uniformly bounded. Its divergence constraint is

$$\partial_R v_r^* + R^{-1} v_r^* + \delta \partial_Z v_z^* = 0.$$

The radial primitive and slice estimates in the preceding proof give the required $O(\delta)$ radial gain. All the mean bounds thus transfer to the physical scale exactly as in Proposition 8.

Angular averaging is orthogonal in the extended isotropic Sobolev spaces too. The exact homogeneous fluctuation equation therefore gives $\|U - \mathcal{P}U\|_{H^8} + \|\partial_s(U - \mathcal{P}U)\|_{H^6} \le C\epsilon$. Its stress and the time derivative of that stress are $O(\epsilon^2)$ in spatial C^3 on a fixed annulus. Direct angular integration gives

$$\mathcal{P}(W_r^{\mathrm{st}} W_\theta^{\mathrm{st}}) = -2R^4 e^{-2R^2-2Z^2} \cos^2\alpha, \tag{42}$$

$$\mathcal{P}(W_r^{\mathrm{hel}} W_\theta^{\mathrm{hel}}) = -2R^4 e^{-2R^2-2Z^2}. \tag{43}$$

The latter gives the same initial circulation and radial rates as in the preceding proof, and the initial axial rate of the critical point is zero. The mean equation again bounds its circulation time derivatives by $C(\delta + \eta + \epsilon^2)$. Use the two-variable implicit function theorem for the negative definite meridional Hessian. The initial inward radial rate and positive circulation rate persist on a universal interval when $\delta + \eta$ is sufficiently small compared with ϵ^2. This proves the assertions about the moving critical point without assuming that its axial coordinate stays zero. At the fixed point $(y_h, Z, \alpha) = ((1,0),0,0)$ the initial defect is $\epsilon(-2/e, 0, 0)$. Its uniform $O(\epsilon)$ time-derivative bound proves the same critical-history lower bound.

For the standing field put $G = R(\mathcal{P}U)_\theta$ and $J = \delta\partial_Z + \partial_\alpha$. Initially the mean has no meridional component, so its exact equation is

$$G_s = \eta(G_{RR} - R^{-1}G_R + J^2 G) + 4\epsilon^2 R^4(3 - 2R^2)e^{-2R^2-2Z^2}\cos^2\alpha \quad \text{at } s = 0.$$

At $(R, Z, \alpha) = (1, 0, 0)$ define $F(s) = J^2 G(1, 0, 0, s)$. The two exact initial values are

$$F(0) = -4\delta^2/e, \qquad F'(0) = \eta\delta^2(16 + 24\delta^2)/e - \epsilon^2(16\delta^2 + 8)/e^2.$$

The uniform time and space bounds above give $|F''(s)| \le C$. For sufficiently small δ, $F'(0) \le -4\epsilon^2/e^2$. Choosing a universal small $c_3 > 0$, Taylor's theorem at $s_* = c_3\epsilon^2$ gives $F(s_*) \le -c\epsilon^4$. On restriction and physical rescaling,

$$\partial_{zz}(\mathcal{P}u_\lambda^{\mathrm{st}})_\theta(\lambda^{-1}, 0, t_*) = A\lambda^2 F(s_*).$$

Since $\tau_* \ge \lambda^{-2}/2$ for large λ, this is (41).

Finally angular integration makes the helical defect's squared norm independent of its phase; it is $\frac{9}{2}g_2$ before the factor ϵ^2. The standing defect's squared norm is instead

$$\tfrac{9}{4}g_2(1 + e^{-1/(2\delta^2)}).$$

Both are orthogonal to V. This proves the energy and relative-defect claims, while the common initial mean is AV. □

The standing example disproves a uniform propagation claim based only on the displayed initial controls. It does not disprove a bound depending on the full initial datum. The helical example shows why an argument cannot assume that fast axial oscillations must destroy the mean geometry. Its exact phase symmetry concerns one family; superposing families with different phase relations need not preserve it. The uniform Sobolev control proved here still ends after a fixed normalized time. Neither example establishes a recurrent cascade or an arbitrary-data history bound.

7.2 A mean mode generated by incompatible parents

Two individually helical parents need not share a helical symmetry. Their interaction can create a fast mean mode even when their initial mean stress has no fast axial phase. The next example keeps that mode as a physical Fourier projection of the actual solution.

Fix a real even Schwartz function g whose Fourier transform is smooth, nonnegative, supported in $[-1,1]$, and has nonzero mass away from zero. Normalize $g(0)=1$; then $g''(0)<0$. In the horizontal variables put $q=y_1+iy_2$, $a=|y_h|^2$, and

$$V_h=\operatorname{curl}_h(e^{-a}e_z),\qquad W_2=\operatorname{curl}_h(q^2e^{-a}e_z),\qquad W_4=\operatorname{curl}_h\left(q^4(1-2a/5)e^{-a}e_z\right).$$

The last two velocities are complex; their real parts will be used. For $0<h\le 1/6$ define

$$\delta=\lambda^{-2h},\quad \epsilon=\lambda^{-h}=\sqrt{\delta},\quad \mu=\lambda^{1-2h},\quad C_\epsilon=\pi\,\|g\|_2^2\,(1+9\epsilon^2/5),\quad A=\lambda^{1+2h}/\sqrt{C_\epsilon}.$$

In this subsection C_ϵ denotes this normalization. Take the real initial datum

$$u_\lambda(x_h,z)=Ag(\mu z)\left[V_h(\lambda x_h)+\epsilon\,\mathrm{Re}\left((W_2+W_4)(\lambda x_h)e^{2i\lambda z}\right)\right]. \tag{44}$$

Let Q_λ be angular averaging followed by the axial Fourier projection onto $\lambda\le|k_z|\le 3\lambda$, with the Fourier convention e^{ik_zz}. This is an orthogonal projection in L^2, preserves solenoidality and commutes with the Laplacian.

Proposition 10. *For each fixed $\nu>0$ and $0<h\le 1/6$, and all sufficiently large λ, the actual unforced evolution from (44) exists until $t_\lambda=s_*/(A\lambda)$, for a fixed $s_*>0$. Its initial squared energy is $\lambda^{-1+6h}\le 1$, its relative L^2 angular defect is $3\epsilon/\sqrt{5}\to 0$, and its initial mean satisfies (1)–(2) with a uniform constant. On this interval its critical fluctuation history is uniformly bounded:*

$$\int_0^{t_\lambda}\|u(t)-\mathcal{P}u(t)\|_\infty^2\,\mathrm{d}t\le C.$$

Set $Y=Q_\lambda u$ and

$$E_Y=\tfrac12\|\nabla Y\|_2^2,\qquad D_Y=\nu\|\Delta Y\|_2^2,\qquad P_Y=\langle-\Delta Y,Q_\lambda\mathcal{N}(u)\rangle,\quad \mathcal{N}(u)=-\mathbb{P}[(u\cdot\nabla)u].$$

Here $\mathbb{P}$ is the physical Leray projection. Exactly $Y(0)=Y_t(0)=0$, while at the last time

$$c\lambda^{-1}\le\|Y(t_\lambda)\|_2^2\le C\lambda^{-1}, \tag{45}$$

$$\int_0^{t_\lambda}P_Y(t)\,\mathrm{d}t\ge c\lambda,\qquad\qquad \int_0^{t_\lambda}D_Y(t)\,\mathrm{d}t\le C\nu\lambda^{1-2h}. \tag{46}$$

Moreover, with $\tau_\lambda=\lambda^{-2}-t_\lambda>0$,

$$\tau_\lambda^{3/2-h}\left|\partial_{zz}(\mathcal{P}u)_\theta(\lambda^{-1},\pi/(2\lambda),t_\lambda)\right|\ge c\lambda^h. \tag{47}$$

The constants s_*,c,C depend on the fixed envelope and profiles, not on λ,ν,h; the lower threshold on λ may depend on ν,h.

Proof. Use the extended construction above, now with $D = (\partial_1, \partial_2, \delta\partial_Z + 2\partial_\alpha)$, initial field

$$U(0) = g(Z)\left[V_h + \epsilon\,\mathrm{Re}((W_2 + W_4)e^{i\alpha})\right],$$

and $\eta = \nu\lambda/A$. Restrict to $\alpha = 2Z/\delta$ and then rescale as before. Work initially with a uniform H^{30} bound on the extended local interval. The projection remains a contraction, with symbol corresponding to $(k_h, \delta k_Z + 2n)$, so the same existence, trace and uniqueness arguments apply.

We first compute the relevant cubic jet at $\delta = 0$. Label a mode by its horizontal angular index and its phase index (m, n). The parents have labels $(2,1), (4,1)$ and their negatives. The only three-parent sum with label $(0,1)$ is $(2,1) + (2,1) - (4,1)$. No single parent or pair, even including the $(0,0)$ base, reaches it. Linear derivatives preserve these labels. Thus neither the base nor any term containing viscosity contributes to this mode in $U_{ss}(0)$.

The two intermediate pressure equations have explicit decaying solutions. Suppressing the common factor $g(Z)^2$, they are

$$p_{22} = -q^4 e^{-2a}, \qquad p_{2\bar{4}} = \frac{\bar{q}^2}{5}(4a^3 + 18a^2 - 62a + 9)e^{-2a}.$$

The first solves the pressure equation with axial wave number 4, so its elliptic operator is $-\Delta_h + 16$; the second has zero axial wave number and operator $-\Delta_h$. Their sources are the divergences of $(W_2 \cdot D)W_2$ and $(W_2 \cdot D)\overline{W}_4 + (\overline{W}_4 \cdot D)W_2$, respectively. Direct differentiation verifies both equations and the solenoidality of their full quadratic velocity sources, including the axial pressure component. Decay removes a harmonic ambiguity.

Insert these two sources into both orders of the outer convection. The final pressure has zero angular index and hence no azimuthal component. The resulting circulation coefficient is

$$C_\Gamma(R) = \frac{8}{5}R^4(8R^8 - 110R^6 + 346R^4 - 275R^2 + 27)e^{-3R^2}, \qquad C_\Gamma(1) = -\frac{32}{5e^3}. \tag{48}$$

Each real signed parent has amplitude $\epsilon/2$. Including the conjugate output, the fast mean part of $G_{ss}(0)$, where $G = R(\mathcal{P}U)_\theta$, is therefore

$$\frac{\epsilon^3}{4} g(Z)^3 C_\Gamma(R)\cos\alpha. \tag{49}$$

The zero-phase mean can have additional terms; it is not discarded from the evolution. The lab checker verifies the two pressure equations, every contributing convection branch, and the real-field normalization in (49).

A bound uniform in the small amplitude is needed to use this jet. For this purpose hold η fixed while differentiating in ϵ; all estimates will be uniform for $0 \le \eta \le 1$. If $v_j = \partial_\epsilon^j U$, its equation is the linearized projected equation about U, with additional source

$$-\mathbb{P}_{\delta,*}\sum_{k=1}^{j-1}\binom{j}{k}(v_k \cdot D)v_{j-k}.$$

The transport energy estimate gives uniform bounds for v_j in H^{30-2j} for $j \le 3$. Difference quotients justify these finite parameter derivatives in the lower Sobolev spaces. Three time derivatives cost at most six additional spatial derivatives, leaving a uniform H^{18} bound for the mixed derivatives needed here. No analyticity of the solution map in a fixed Sobolev norm is assumed.

At $\epsilon = 0$, the evolving base has label $(0,0)$, so its linearized equation preserves (m, n). The first parameter derivative has only the four parent labels, and the second only their pairwise sums.

Neither has angular index zero with nonzero phase index. Taylor's theorem in ϵ consequently bounds the entire fast angular mean, including its first three time derivatives in the required spatial norms, by $C\epsilon^3$ throughout a common interval.

The physical projection Q_λ also sees high frequencies of the evolving zero-phase mean. Its slow axial Fourier support is not claimed to remain compact. Six bounded Z derivatives instead make this contribution at most $C\delta^6$, also after the needed spatial and time derivatives. Since $\epsilon = \sqrt{\delta}$, this is bounded by $C\epsilon^3$. The phase trace bound transfers the other components to the actual physical restriction.

At the initial time the support assertions are exact. The initial zero phase has axial support at most μ, its quadratic sources at most 2μ, and its cubic sources at most 3μ. When $\delta < 1/3$ these are below the receiving band. The new phases $n = \pm 1$ in the cubic jet lie in $\pm 2\lambda + [-3\mu, 3\mu]$, wholly inside that band. The pressure multipliers do not enlarge axial Fourier support. This proves $Y(0) = Y_t(0) = 0$ and identifies its second derivative.

In normalized physical coordinates, let $\widetilde{Y}$ denote this recipient and $D_\delta = (\partial_1, \partial_2, \delta\partial_Z)$. The preceding bounds give, in the norm controlling up to two D_δ derivatives,

$$\widetilde{Y}(s) = \tfrac{1}{2}\epsilon^3 s^2 C_\delta + O(\epsilon^3 s^3). \tag{50}$$

The coefficient has uniformly bounded norms. Its phase coefficients converge in Sobolev spaces to the nonzero coefficient just computed: the Leray multipliers converge almost everywhere and are uniformly bounded, so dominated convergence applies to the fixed smooth inputs. The two physical axial bands are disjoint, and on them $|\delta k_Z| \geq 1$. It follows that both $\|C_\delta\|_2$ and $\|D_\delta C_\delta\|_2$ have positive uniform lower bounds for small δ.

Choose a fixed small $s_* > 0$ in (50). Then the recipient's squared velocity and gradient norms at s_* are bounded above and below by constant multiples of ϵ^6, and

$$\eta \int_0^{s_*} \left\| \Delta_\delta \widetilde{Y}(s) \right\|_2^2 \, \mathrm{d}s \leq C\eta\epsilon^6.$$

Physical squared velocity norms acquire the factor $A^2/(\lambda^2\mu)$, and squared gradient norms acquire A^2/μ. Since $\epsilon^6 = \lambda^{-6h}$, these factors yield (45), a recipient enstrophy of order λ, and the dissipation bound in (46). The exact projected energy identity is

$$E_Y'(t) + D_Y(t) = P_Y(t).$$

Since $E_Y(0) = 0$, it proves the signed production lower bound without replacing the nonlinear work by its absolute value.

For the mean geometry put $J = \delta\partial_Z + 2\partial_\alpha$ and evaluate $F(s) = J^2 G(1, \pi\delta/2, \pi, s)$. Initially $F(0)$ is negative of order δ^2, because $g''(0) < 0$, and $F'(0) = O(\eta\delta^2)$. Each initial parent has zero mean radial–azimuthal stress, and their cross stress has nonzero angular index; hence there is no initial fast mean torque. Equations (48)–(49) give the fast part

$$F''(0) = -\frac{32}{5e^3}\epsilon^3 + o(\epsilon^3)$$

as $\delta \to 0$; the zero phase contributes only $O(\delta^2)$. Moreover $|F'''| \leq C(\epsilon^3 + \delta^2)$ by the phase-selection estimate. Here $\delta^2 = o(\epsilon^3)$. After reducing the fixed s_*, Taylor's theorem gives $F(s_*) \leq -c\epsilon^3$. The initial negative term absorbs the $O(\eta\delta^2 s_*)$ term uniformly for $\eta \leq 1$. The physical axial derivative equals $A\lambda^2 F(s_*)$ at the point in (47). Since $\lambda^{-2} - t_\lambda \geq \lambda^{-2}/2$ for large λ, the normalized lower bound is $c\epsilon^3\lambda^{4h} = c\lambda^h$.

The first parameter-derivative estimate also gives $\|U - \mathcal{P}U\|_\infty \le C\epsilon$ on the common interval, since the zero-amplitude solution is angularly symmetric. Therefore the physical fluctuation history is bounded by $CA^2\epsilon^2/(A\lambda) = C/\sqrt{C_\epsilon}$, uniformly in the concentration.

Finally the horizontal squared norms of V_h, $\operatorname{Re} W_2$ and $\operatorname{Re} W_4$ are π, $3\pi/4$ and $21\pi/20$. Distinct angular indices make all cross energies zero. This proves the normalization and relative-defect assertions. □

This receiving sector starts empty and is generated by the actual unforced parents. Its signed production exceeds its own viscous cost by an unbounded factor across the family, while its kinetic energy remains small. This does not refute a signed budget for the full high-frequency tail: the parents are in the same axial band, outside the angular mean, and their signed work must also be included. The initial higher norms grow with λ, so a data-dependent history allowance and a recurrent estimate from one fixed datum remain possible. Nor does the example prove that a possible singularity must preserve the mean geometry assumed in Theorem 1.

7.3 Positive total work after including the parents

The preceding receiving-sector calculation does not determine the sign of the total work. A single helical parent gives a separate test of that sign, with its pressure and the response of the base included. Use the envelope g, base V_h, and parent W_2 defined above. Fix $\nu > 0$ and $0 < h \le 1/6$. With a constant $b > 0$ to be chosen, put

$$\delta = \lambda^{-2h}, \quad \epsilon = b\lambda^{-h}, \quad \mu = \lambda\delta, \quad C_\epsilon = \pi\,\|g\|_2^2\,(1 + 3\epsilon^2/4), \quad A = \lambda^{1+2h}/\sqrt{C_\epsilon},$$

and take

$$u_\lambda(x_h, z) = Ag(\mu z)[V_h(\lambda x_h) + \epsilon\,\mathrm{Re}(W_2(\lambda x_h)e^{2i\lambda z})]. \tag{51}$$

Here $\epsilon \le 1$ for all sufficiently large λ.

Proposition 11. *One can choose b depending on ν so that the actual unforced evolutions from (51) exist until $t_\lambda = s_*/(A\lambda)$ and satisfy*

$$\frac{1}{2}\,\|\nabla u(t_\lambda)\|_2^2 - \frac{1}{2}\,\|\nabla u(0)\|_2^2 \ge c\lambda^{1+4h}. \tag{52}$$

Their initial squared energies are $\lambda^{-1+6h} \le 1$, their relative angular defects tend to zero, and their means obey (1)–(2) throughout this interval, with $\tau = \lambda^{-2} - t$ and a constant independent of λ. Also $\int_0^{t_\lambda} \|u - \mathcal{P}u\|_\infty^2\,\mathrm{d}t \le Cb^2$.

Consequently, for every fixed Fourier cutoff $K < \infty$ and $\theta \le 1$, the high-frequency projection $u_{\ge K}$ satisfies

$$\int_0^{t_\lambda} \left[\langle -\Delta u_{\ge K}, \mathcal{N}(u)\rangle - \theta\nu\,\|\Delta u_{\ge K}\|_2^2\right]\mathrm{d}t \longrightarrow +\infty. \tag{53}$$

The projection uses the physical convention $e^{ik\cdot x}$ and $|k| \ge K$. The constants in this proposition are independent of λ; no constant uniform over full initial Sobolev norms is claimed.

Proof. First compute the full signed response at $\delta = \eta = 0$, with $\eta = \nu\lambda/A$, per unit fast axial phase and with the slow envelope temporarily suppressed. More generally let the fast carrier be $\kappa > 0$. Write

$$v(R) = 2Re^{-R^2}, \qquad f(R) = R^2e^{-R^2},$$
$$\Omega = v/R, \quad \zeta = v' + v/R, \quad d = v' - v/R, \quad L_2 = \partial_{RR} + R^{-1}\partial_R - 4R^{-2}.$$

The complex parent has cylindrical components $(2if/R, -f', 0)$ and phase $e^{2i\phi+i\alpha}$. Its linear pressure amplitude p solves

$$(-L_2 + \kappa^2)p = F, \qquad F(R) = 32R^2(R^2-1)e^{-2R^2}. \tag{54}$$

This source is twice the trace of the base and parent velocity-gradient matrices; the cylindrical basis derivatives are included.

Let $\Pi = \int \omega \cdot (\omega \cdot \nabla)u$ denote the total signed enstrophy production, and let $\mathcal{F} = (\omega \cdot \nabla)u$. In an unforced inviscid evolution the material identities give

$$(\partial_t + u \cdot \nabla)\mathcal{F} = -(\nabla^2 p)\omega, \qquad \Pi' = \int (|\mathcal{F}|^2 - \omega \cdot \nabla^2 p\, \omega).$$

Indeed the two products of velocity gradients cancel when differentiating $\mathcal{F}$; transport integrates to zero. The coefficient of ϵ^2 in this identity is

$$c_\kappa = \pi\kappa^2 \int_0^\infty Rd[4\zeta f^2/R^2 - 2\Omega(f')^2]\,\mathrm{d}R + 2\pi\kappa^2 \int_0^\infty Rp\zeta' f'\,\mathrm{d}R.$$

The first integral is exactly zero. In the second, the vertical parent vorticity $-L_2 f$ cancels the term $\zeta L_2 f$ from the horizontal pressure pairing. Omitting that component gives an incorrect coefficient. The second-order pressure makes no further contribution: its pairing with the two base vorticities is an axial second derivative whose phase average is zero.

The remaining sign can be proved explicitly. The angular heat kernel is

$$e^{tL_2}(R^2 e^{-\beta R^2}) = \frac{R^2}{(1+4\beta t)^3} e^{-\beta R^2/(1+4\beta t)}.$$

Differentiate in β to heat F. Gaussian integration gives

$$J(t) := \int_0^\infty R(e^{tL_2}F)\zeta' f'\,\mathrm{d}R = \frac{5 - 24t - 256t^3}{2(1+4t)^6}.$$

Although J changes sign, its primitive is strictly positive:

$$B(t) = \int_0^t J(s)\,\mathrm{d}s = \frac{t(128t^4 + 160t^3 + 112t^2 + 28t + 5)}{2(1+4t)^5} > 0 \quad (t > 0), \qquad B(\infty) = \frac{1}{16}.$$

The decaying resolvent in (54) and integration by parts therefore yield

$$c_\kappa = 2\pi\kappa^2 \int_0^\infty e^{-\kappa^2 t} J(t)\,\mathrm{d}t = 2\pi\kappa^4 \int_0^\infty e^{-\kappa^2 t} B(t)\,\mathrm{d}t > 0. \tag{55}$$

All radial boundary terms vanish by smoothness at the axis and decay. The checker verifies the source, both pressure components, the heat equation and the displayed primitive. These are exact identities; positivity follows from the integral formula, not a numerical sign test.

Return to the actual extended flow with $D_3 = \delta\partial_Z + 2\partial_\alpha$ and initial field $g(Z)[V_h + \epsilon\,\mathrm{Re}(W_2 e^{i\alpha})]$. The preserved joint rotation–phase symmetry from Proposition 9 makes every horizontally integrated rotation-invariant density independent of α. Its physical trace and its phase average consequently have the same integral. In particular the computation above applies to the actual physical enstrophy, not to an ensemble of different solutions.

Let $\mathcal{P}_{\mathrm{tot}}(s)$ be this total normalized production. Initially $\mathcal{P}_{\mathrm{tot}}(0) = 0$ exactly. For a horizontal solenoidal initial field, the integrated production is $-\int(\partial_z u_h)\cdot(\nabla_h u_h)(\partial_z u_h)$. Here the terms with

two envelope derivatives vanish by the planar kinetic identity, the terms with two phase derivatives vanish after angular averaging, and the remaining terms integrate a multiple of $g^2 g'$ over Z, which is zero.

We justify a time interval uniform in ϵ, δ, η. The extended transport estimate and finite parameter derivatives used in Proposition 10 give uniform Sobolev bounds for three time derivatives and two amplitude derivatives, with ample derivative margin. Hold η independent of ϵ in these estimates. Rotation by $\pi/2$ changes ϵ to $-\epsilon$, so the physically integrated production and its time derivatives are even functions of ϵ.

For the zero-amplitude solution, the vertical velocity and its needed time derivatives are $O(\delta)$ in Sobolev norms: their equations have pressure source $-\delta \partial_Z p$ and zero initial vertical velocity. The double-Riesz representation bounds p uniformly. Thus the horizontal vorticity and the mixed axial strains are $O(\delta)$, while $\partial_z U_z = O(\delta^2)$. The same assertions hold after the required time derivatives. Every contribution to production at zero amplitude is therefore $O(\delta^2)$. Evenness and the amplitude estimates imply

$$|\mathcal{P}''_{\mathrm{tot}}(s)| \le C(\delta^2 + \epsilon^2) \tag{56}$$

on a common normalized interval.

At time zero, the quartic inviscid production derivative has expansion

$$\mathcal{P}'_{\mathrm{tot}}(0) = O(\delta^2) + \epsilon^2(c_2 \|g\|_4^4 + o(1)) + O(\epsilon^4) + O(\eta\epsilon^2).$$

The $o(1)$ tends to zero with δ: the Leray multipliers converge almost everywhere, are uniformly bounded, and act on fixed smooth inputs. The purely viscous zero-amplitude term is zero because the heat evolution remains purely azimuthal. All constants are uniform for the parameters at most one. With $\epsilon^2 = b^2\delta$ and $\eta = \nu\sqrt{C_\epsilon}\delta$, it follows that $\mathcal{P}'_{\mathrm{tot}}(0) \ge c\epsilon^2$ for sufficiently large λ. Equation (56) and $\mathcal{P}_{\mathrm{tot}}(0) = 0$ then give, for a fixed small $s_* > 0$,

$$\int_0^{s_*} \mathcal{P}_{\mathrm{tot}}(s)\,\mathrm{d}s \ge c\epsilon^2, \qquad \eta \int_0^{s_*} \|\Delta_D U(s)\|_2^2\,\mathrm{d}s \le C\eta.$$

Both enstrophy integrals acquire the physical factor A^2/μ. Since C_ϵ is bounded above and below, choosing b sufficiently large compared with $\sqrt{\nu}$ makes the difference at least $c\lambda^{1+4h}$. The exact enstrophy identity proves (52). The symmetry, incompressibility, and uniform Sobolev estimates prove the persistent mean geometry as in Proposition 9. The amplitude derivative gives $\|U - \mathcal{P}U\|_\infty \le C\epsilon$, so the history is at most $CA\epsilon^2/\lambda \le Cb^2$. Orthogonality of angular modes gives the asserted initial energy.

Finally write $E_{\ge K} = \|\nabla u_{\ge K}\|_2^2/2$. The kinetic energy identity bounds the complementary gradient energy by $K^2/2$. Hence its subtraction changes the enstrophy increment by at most $K^2/2$. The exact projected identity gives

$$\int_0^{t_\lambda} (P_{\ge K} - \theta D_{\ge K})\,\mathrm{d}t = E_{\ge K}(t_\lambda) - E_{\ge K}(0) + (1-\theta)\int_0^{t_\lambda} D_{\ge K}\,\mathrm{d}t \ge c\lambda^{1+4h} - K^2/2,$$

where $D_{\ge K} = \nu\|\Delta u_{\ge K}\|_2^2$. This proves (53). □

This example includes the full parent response and preserves the displayed mean geometry on its short interval. It excludes a uniform signed-tail allowance based only on the bounded quantities just listed, with a fixed cutoff. It does not exclude a cutoff or allowance depending on the full datum: the initial enstrophy itself is of order λ^{1+6h}, larger than the increase just proved. No sequence of these events within one fixed solution, and no failure of the conditional regularity theorem, is asserted.

7.4 The generated seed couples to a growing linearized component

The mean mode in Proposition 10 is not automatically a growing perturbation of the base. The following calculation checks that coupling, but only for the inviscid linearization about the fixed column $v(R)e_\theta = 2Re^{-R^2}e_\theta$. This distinction matters: in the nonlinear evolution the parents and the mean keep changing. The norms below are radial Fourier-mode norms; the fixed column itself is not a finite-energy field on the whole space. The columnar-vortex linearization is classical; see, for example, [3, Eq. (1.6)]. The stability assumptions of that reference are not satisfied by this column, whose vorticity changes sign.

In the axisymmetric axial mode $e^{i\kappa z}$, write the velocity components as (a, b, c). At $\kappa = 2$ their linearized equations are

$$a_s - 2\Omega b = -p_R, \qquad b_s + \zeta a = 0, \qquad c_s = -2ip, \qquad a_R + a/R + 2ic = 0, \tag{57}$$

$$\Omega = 2e^{-R^2}, \qquad \zeta = 4(1-R^2)e^{-R^2}, \qquad \Phi = 2\Omega\zeta = 16(1-R^2)e^{-2R^2}. \tag{58}$$

In $H = L^2((0,\infty), R\,\mathrm{d}R)$ let A be the Friedrichs realization of

$$I - \tfrac{1}{4}L_1, \qquad L_1 = \partial_{RR} + R^{-1}\partial_R - R^{-2}.$$

Its quadratic form, initially on $C_c^\infty(0,\infty)$, is

$$\mathfrak{a}(f,f) = \int_0^\infty R\left[|f|^2 + \tfrac{1}{4}(|f'|^2 + |f/R|^2)\right]\,\mathrm{d}R.$$

Thus $A \geq I$, and $B = -A^{-1/2}\Phi A^{-1/2}$ is a bounded self-adjoint operator on H. No discrete-spectrum assumption will be needed. Elimination of the pressure in (57) gives

$$Aa_s = 2\Omega b, \qquad Aa_{ss} = -\Phi a, \qquad x_{ss} = Bx, \quad x = A^{1/2}a.$$

Conversely these equations recover (57) using $b_s = -\zeta a$, $c = i(a_R + a/R)/2$, and $p = -(a_{sR} + a_s/R)/4$. The form domain imposes the regular axis boundary condition. The Gaussian test functions below lie in the form domain by radial cutoff approximation, and their distributional Af lies in H. Integration by parts and form density therefore put them in the operator domain as well.

Put $q = R^2$ and $Q_4(q) = 8q^4 - 110q^3 + 346q^2 - 275q + 27$. The full cubic source computed in Proposition 10, before its last Leray projection, has components

$$iP_r = \frac{8i}{5}R(8q^4 + 136q^3 - 262q^2 + 27q + 18)e^{-3q},$$

$$P_\theta = \frac{8}{5}R^3Q_4(q)e^{-3q}, \qquad P_z = -\frac{32}{5}R^6(6q^2 - 25q + 20)e^{-3q}.$$

The checker verifies all three components. Its divergence is purely imaginary, so the last pressure amplitude is purely imaginary too. Consequently the fully projected source C has a purely imaginary radial component, the real azimuthal component P_θ, and a real axial component. Here C is the unscaled complex cubic coefficient; the real initial jet in (49) has the additional factor $\epsilon^3 g(Z)^3/4$.

Proposition 12. *Initialize the fixed-column linearized equation (57) with the fully projected coefficient C. Its meridional components satisfy, for all $s \geq 0$,*

$$\left(\|a(s)\|_H^2 + \|c(s)\|_H^2\right)^{1/2} \geq \frac{\sqrt{20}}{40}\sinh(s/\sqrt{20}).$$

This is a statement about the complex Fourier coefficient in the fixed inviscid linearization. It is not a growth bound for the actual nonlinear solution from Proposition 10.

Proof. The radial second-order equation has real coefficients. Set $x_{\mathrm{R}} = \operatorname{Re} x$. Then $x_{\mathrm{R}}(0) = 0$ and

$$(x_{\mathrm{R}})_s(0) = z := A^{-1/2}h, \qquad h = 2\Omega P_\theta = \tfrac{32}{5}R^3Q_4(R^2)e^{-4R^2}.$$

The imaginary meridional part of the generated seed cannot cancel this real solution in the complex Hilbert norm. It suffices to prove that the spectral projection of z onto $B > 1/20$ has norm greater than $1/40$.

Here is a finite rational certificate. Let L_j^1 denote the generalized Laguerre polynomial, and set

$$f(R) = 10^{-5}Re^{-R^2}\sum_{j=0}^{31} d_j L_j^1(2R^2), \qquad \mu = \frac{21}{200}, \qquad \mathcal{R} = -\Phi f - \mu A f.$$

The coefficients $d_0, \dots, d_{31}$, in row order, are

$$\begin{array}{rrrrrrrr} 129288 & -103710 & 405 & 2339 & 11058 & 4912 & 3067 & 42 \\ -645 & -1238 & -1012 & -844 & -499 & -285 & -77 & 28 \\ 104 & 123 & 128 & 110 & 91 & 65 & 46 & 25 \\ 14 & 0 & -3 & -13 & -8 & -18 & -6 & -19 \end{array}.$$

Exact Gaussian integration gives the strict inequalities

$$\mathfrak{a}(f,f) < \frac{101}{100}, \qquad \langle h, f\rangle > \frac{27}{100}, \qquad \|h\|_H^2 < 28, \qquad \|\mathcal{R}\|_H^2 < \frac{1}{160000}. \tag{59}$$

The accompanying checker constructs the polynomial coefficients and integrates each monomial using $\int_0^\infty q^n e^{-tq}\,\mathrm{d}q = n!/t^{n+1}$. All comparisons use rational arithmetic, without a numerical eigensolver or rounded quadrature. It independently checks the form norm against the differential expression for Af.

To see why these four inequalities suffice, put $y = A^{1/2}f$ and let E_- be the spectral projection onto $B \le \rho$, where $\rho = 1/20$. Then

$$(B-\mu)y = A^{-1/2}\mathcal{R}, \qquad \|E_- y\|_H \le \frac{\|\mathcal{R}\|_H}{\mu - \rho}, \qquad \langle z, y\rangle = \langle h, f\rangle.$$

Use $\left\|A^{-1/2}\right\| \le 1$ and $\mu - \rho = 11/200$. Equation (59) gives

$$|\langle E_- z, E_- y\rangle| < \frac{(16/3)(1/400)}{11/200} = \frac{8}{33}, \qquad \|y\|_H < \frac{101}{100}.$$

Since $27/100 - 8/33 > (101/100)/40$, Cauchy–Schwarz yields $\|(I - E_-)z\|_H > 1/40$.

The bounded self-adjoint equation $(x_{\mathrm{R}})_{ss} = Bx_{\mathrm{R}}$ with $x_{\mathrm{R}}(0) = 0$ has, on the positive spectral subspace, multiplier $\sinh(s\sqrt{\sigma})/\sqrt{\sigma}$ applied to z. For $\sigma > \rho$ this multiplier is at least $\sinh(s\sqrt{\rho})/\sqrt{\rho}$, as follows directly from its power series. Thus

$$\|x_{\mathrm{R}}(s)\|_H \ge \frac{\sqrt{20}}{40}\sinh(s/\sqrt{20}).$$

Finally incompressibility and the radial integration by parts give $\|a\|_H^2 + \|c\|_H^2 = \mathfrak{a}(a,a) = \|x\|_H^2$. This also follows by density from the form domain and completes the proof. □

The certificate establishes coupling to growth, not persistence of the actual forcing that created the seed. At cubic order the evolving parents drive an inhomogeneous equation. Their subsequent signed contributions could reinforce or offset the initial one; a nonzero initial jet does not determine that history. Viscosity, the slow envelope, and a controlled longer nonlinear time interval also remain to be included. The classical fixed-column instability and this explicit seed coupling supply none of the arbitrary-data physical-time budget required for continuation.

7.5 A signed numerical history with evolving parents

The cubic amplitude variation provides a finite test of the preceding distinction. Label modes by their angular and axial indices, with physical axial wave number twice the latter. Write $a = (2, 1)$, $b = (-4, -1)$, $d = (4, 2)$, $e = (-2, 0)$, and $c = (0, 1)$. If $\mathcal{L}_j$ is the full inviscid linearization about V_h on mode j, and $\mathcal{B}(u, v) = -\mathbb{P}[(u \cdot \nabla)v]$, the exact ancestry of the cubic recipient is

$$\begin{aligned} a' &= \mathcal{L}_a a, & b' &= \mathcal{L}_b b, \\ d' &= \mathcal{L}_d d + \mathcal{B}(a, a), & e' &= \mathcal{L}_e e + \mathcal{B}(a, b) + \mathcal{B}(b, a), \\ c' &= \mathcal{L}_c c + \mathcal{B}(a, e) + \mathcal{B}(e, a) + \mathcal{B}(b, d) + \mathcal{B}(d, b). \end{aligned}$$

Initially $a = W_2$, $b = \overline{W_4}$, and $d = e = c = 0$. Every intermediate Leray projection is retained. In particular $c'(0) = 0$ and $c''(0)$ is the full cubic coefficient checked in Proposition 10. These coefficients are unscaled: the real datum's contribution at this order is $\epsilon^3 \operatorname{Re}(c(s)e^{2iz})/4$.

Let $f, \mu, R = -\Phi f - \mu A f$ be the rational test and its residual from Proposition 12, and put $\gamma = \sqrt{\mu}$. If a_c, b_c are the radial and azimuthal components of the recipient, define the complex scalar

$$q_c = \gamma \langle Af, a_c \rangle_H + \langle 2\Omega f, b_c \rangle_H .$$

Writing F_c for its evolving nonlinear source, the exact axisymmetric linear equations give

$$q_c' - \gamma q_c = \langle R, a_c \rangle_H + \gamma \langle Af, F_{c,r} \rangle_H + \langle 2\Omega f, F_{c,\theta} \rangle_H .$$

Thus the discounted Duhamel integral includes both the forcing and the explicit residual. Treating f as an exact eigenfunction would lose the first term.

The executable `labs/cubic_history.py` uses a horizontal Fourier Galerkin approximation on a periodic square, exact axial labels, two-thirds dealiasing and fourth-order Runge–Kutta integration. The square only approximates rotational symmetry. At normalized time $s = 3$, representative refinements give

N	side length	Δs	$\|c\|$	$\operatorname{Re} q_c$	$\operatorname{Im} q_c$
256	14	0.01	42.91325951	−1.21208574	3.95253213
384	14	0.005	42.91326093	−1.21208576	3.95253214
512	20	0.005	42.91325937	−1.21208472	3.95253107

Here $\|c\|^2 = (2\pi)^{-1} \int_{\mathbb{R}^2} |c|^2$, approximated by the square integral. The signed forcing integral changes its real sign between $s = 1.8$ and $s = 2.1$, while its imaginary part remains positive. At $s = 3$ the larger-domain run gives approximately $-0.45855706 + 1.49483206i$. The complete discrete Duhamel ledger closes to less than $4 \cdot 10^{-11}$ in these runs.

These are numerical diagnostics, not validated continuum error bounds. The ledger checks an internal identity, not the accuracy of the PDE approximation. The calculation is a cubic variation about a stationary inviscid column, not the full nonlinear viscous flow or a finite-energy whole-space background. It neither determines the infinite-time signed integral nor controls a nonlinear remainder on a growing time interval.

The separate program `labs/full_history.py` evolves the complete retained velocity from the real mixed-parent datum, with $\epsilon = 0.1$ and normalized viscosity 0.001. It uses a periodic horizontal square of side 14, axial period π, two-thirds dealiasing in all three coordinates and time step 0.005. Neither the mean nor either parent is held fixed. Normalize the spatial integral by $1/(2\pi)$

horizontally and by the axial average. The initial kinetic energy and enstrophy are then 0.2545 and 1.0825. At time $s = 3$:

N	N_z	$\frac{1}{2}\|\nabla U\|^2$	$\int \Pi$	$\eta \int \|\Delta U\|^2$
256	32	1.09416368675	0.07344871143	0.06178502469
384	32	1.09416462772	0.07345183378	0.06178720607

Thus the observed signed production exceeds dissipation by approximately 0.011665. Both discrete energy ledgers close to less than 10^{-11} on the finer grid. Its palinstrophy fraction above 80% of any retained coordinate cutoff is about $1.12 \cdot 10^{-4}$, compared with $8.65 \cdot 10^{-3}$ on the coarser grid; these fractions do not bound the omitted modes. Applying the preceding test to the full positive axial mode and multiplying by $8/\epsilon^3$ gives approximately $-1.01349505 + 2.95094567i$ on the finer grid. This observable includes all retained amplitude orders. These are full nonlinear Galerkin diagnostics, not validated continuum estimates, whole-space evolutions, or evidence of an infinite cascade.

7.6 Stretching need not drain the maximum mean circulation

For the simplest helical parent, the total enstrophy initially curves upward while the mean circulation at its original maximum curves downward. This compensation is not forced by the equation. A change of the radial profile, even one preserving its first two jets at that radius, reverses the second sign.

Put

$$f_0(r) = r^2 e^{-r^2}, \qquad f_1(r) = r^2 e^{-r^2}\left[1 + (r^2 - 1)^3\right], \qquad W_j = \operatorname{curl}_h\left(f_j(r) e^{2i\phi} e_z\right).$$

Consider local Euler evolutions on $\mathbb{R}^2 \times (\mathbb{R}/\pi\mathbb{Z})$ from $V_h + \epsilon \operatorname{Re}(W_j e^{2iz})$. Use per-unit-axial-length integrals for the total production Π_j, and write $G_j = r(\mathcal{P}u_j)_\theta$.

Proposition 13. *At the initial mean-circulation maximum $r = 1$,*

$$G_{j,s}(0) = 0, \qquad G_{j,ss}(0) = \epsilon^2 d_j, \qquad d_0 < 0, \qquad d_1 > \frac{105}{128e^3} > 0.$$

Both profiles have positive total enstrophy curvature:

$$\Pi_j(0) = 0, \qquad \Pi_j'(0) = \epsilon^2 c_j + O(\epsilon^4), \qquad c_0 > 0, \qquad c_1 > \frac{1053\pi}{128}.$$

The initial velocities and their first spatial derivatives agree on the cylinder $r = 1$ for the two profiles.

Proof. The last assertion follows from $f_1 - f_0$ vanishing to order three at $r = 1$. In particular $f_j(1) = e^{-1}$, $f_j'(1) = 0$, and $f_j''(1) = -4e^{-1}$. Set $\Omega = 2e^{-r^2}$ and $\zeta = 4(1 - r^2)e^{-r^2}$. For a real radial profile f, the complex parent components are $(2if/r, -f', 0)$. If p is its linear pressure, the angular mean of the time derivative of its radial/azimuthal stress is

$$T = \frac{1}{2}\left[2\Omega(f')^2 - \frac{4\zeta f^2}{r^2} + f'p' - \frac{4fp}{r^2}\right].$$

The initial stress itself vanishes. At the peak the derivative of the mean-advection term vanishes because the initial mean meridional velocity and the mean circulation gradient vanish. The averaged axial stress has no axial dependence. Consequently

$$d_j = -\frac{1}{r}\partial_r(r^2 T)\Big|_{r=1} = \frac{4}{e}p_j'(1) - \frac{16}{e^3}. \tag{60}$$

There are no higher powers of ϵ in this second derivative: the Euler second time derivative is cubic in the datum, and angular averaging is even in ϵ.

Let $L_2 = \partial_{rr} + r^{-1}\partial_r - 4r^{-2}$, $\mathcal{R} = (-L_2 + 4)^{-1}$ with the smooth decaying radial solution, and $q = r^2 e^{-2r^2}$. The full cylindrical pressure source is $4e^{-r^2}(L_2 f - 2rf' + 8f)$. Direct differentiation gives

$$\begin{aligned} p_0 &= -2q + 24\mathcal{R}q, \\ p_1 &= q\left(-2r^6 + \frac{15}{2}r^4 - \frac{75}{8}r^2 - \frac{57}{32}\right) + \frac{651}{8}\mathcal{R}q. \end{aligned}$$

Thus, with $H = (\mathcal{R}q)'(1)$,

$$p_0'(1) = 4e^{-2} + 24H, \qquad p_1'(1) = \frac{169}{16}e^{-2} + \frac{651}{8}H.$$

The angular heat kernel identifies

$$H = \int_0^\infty e^{-4t}h(t)\,\mathrm{d}t, \qquad h(t) = \frac{2(8t-1)}{(1+8t)^4}e^{-2/(1+8t)}.$$

Writing $v = (1+8t)^{-1}$, its primitive is

$$C(t) = \int_0^t h = \frac{1}{4}\left[\frac{7}{4}e^{-2} - (v^2 + v/2 + 1/4)e^{-2v}\right].$$

It decreases until $t = 1/8$ and then increases to $(7e^{-2} - 1)/16 < 0$. Hence $C(t) < 0$ for every $t > 0$, and integration by parts gives $H = 4\int_0^\infty e^{-4t}C(t)\,\mathrm{d}t < 0$. This proves $d_0 = 96H/e < 0$.

For the opposite sign, discard the positive part of h and use $e^{-4t} \le 1$ on its negative part:

$$H \ge C(1/8) = \frac{7 - 3e}{16}e^{-2} > -\frac{5}{64}e^{-2}.$$

Here the elementary exponential series gives $8/3 < e < 49/18 < 11/4$. Substitution into (60) yields $d_1 > 105/(128e^3)$.

It remains to keep the full signed work, including the parent response. The calculation of Proposition 11 applies to every real radial profile. For f_1 the non-linearized-pressure integral there is $I_0 = 1053/512$, and the heat-pressure pairing is

$$J_1(t) = \frac{9M(t)}{256(1+4t)^{12}},$$

$$\begin{aligned} M(t) = {} & 67108864t^9 + 201326592t^8 + 127401984t^7 \\ & + 60293120t^6 + 7004160t^5 + 3280896t^4 \\ & + 77568t^3 + 51456t^2 + 1680t + 5. \end{aligned}$$

Every coefficient is positive. Therefore

$$c_1 = 4\pi I_0 + 8\pi\int_0^\infty e^{-4t}J_1(t)\,\mathrm{d}t > \frac{1053\pi}{128}.$$

The sign of c_0 was proved in Proposition 11. The checker `labs/helical_mean_feedback.py` verifies the complete gradient and pressure identities, matching jets, resolvent decompositions, heat primitive, and Gaussian integrals with exact symbolic arithmetic. □

The simultaneous growth also survives on a common short interval of actual viscous whole-space solutions.

Corollary 14. *Fix $\nu > 0$, $0 < h \le 1/6$, and the envelope g used in (44). For a sufficiently large fixed b, put*

$$\delta = \lambda^{-2h}, \quad \epsilon = b\sqrt{\delta}, \quad \mu = \lambda\delta, \quad C_\epsilon = \pi \|g\|_2^2 (1 + 27\epsilon^2), \quad A = \lambda^{1+2h}/\sqrt{C_\epsilon},$$

and take initial data $u_\lambda = Ag(\mu z)[V_h(\lambda x_h) + \epsilon \operatorname{Re}(W_1(\lambda x_h)e^{2i\lambda z})]$. For all sufficiently large λ, their unforced viscous evolutions exist through $t_\lambda = s_*/(A\lambda)$ and satisfy

$$\tfrac{1}{2}\|\nabla u(t_\lambda)\|_2^2 - \tfrac{1}{2}\|\nabla u(0)\|_2^2 \ge c\lambda^{1+4h},$$
$$\Gamma(\lambda^{-1}, 0, t_\lambda) - \sup_{r,z} \Gamma(r, z, 0) \ge cb^2, \qquad \Gamma = r(\mathcal{P}u)_\theta.$$

Their initial squared energies are $\lambda^{-1+6h} \le 1$, their relative angular defects tend to zero, their means retain the bounds (1)–(2), and their critical fluctuation histories are at most Cb^2 on this interval. The positive constants are independent of λ.

Proof. The exact horizontal defect energy divided by π is 27. The extended local evolution and amplitude estimates used in Propositions 9 and 11 apply unchanged to this fixed smooth helical profile. Its positive total coefficient gives the enstrophy assertion after choosing b large enough to pay the viscous loss.

For clarity, the mean-circulation assertion requires a separate parameter estimate. Write $\eta = \nu\lambda/A$ and evaluate the normalized mean at $(R, Z) = (1, 0)$. At zero amplitude its vertical velocity is $O(\delta)$ on the common interval. Incompressibility and smoothness at the axis then make its radial velocity $O(\delta^2)$ on fixed radial compact sets, using

$$U_r(R, Z) = -\frac{\delta}{R}\int_0^R \rho\, \partial_Z U_z(\rho, Z)\, \mathrm{d}\rho.$$

Its circulation equation therefore gives a change $O(\delta^2 + \eta)$ at this point. No global radial-velocity norm of order δ^2 is required.

The mean is even in ϵ, by the preserved joint rotation–phase symmetry. Four amplitude derivatives on the same interval give

$$G(s_*, \epsilon, \delta, \eta) - G(s_*, 0, \delta, \eta) = \epsilon^2 D(s_*, \delta, \eta) + O(\epsilon^4).$$

The coefficient converges as $(\delta, \eta) \to (0, 0)$: the extended Leray multipliers converge almost everywhere and are uniformly bounded, and the differentiated local equations have uniform smooth bounds. At the limit, $D(0) = D'(0) = 0$ and $D''(0) = d_1 > 0$ at $Z = 0$, since $g(0) = 1$. Choose a fixed small $s_* > 0$ for which $D(s_*, 0, 0) > 0$. It follows that

$$G(s_*) - G(0) \ge c\epsilon^2 - C(\delta^2 + \eta) - C\epsilon^4.$$

Since $\epsilon^2 = b^2\delta$ and $\eta = \nu\sqrt{C_\epsilon}\delta$, a fixed large b makes this at least $c\epsilon^2$ for large λ. Multiplication by A/λ gives the asserted cb^2 physical increase. Initially the evaluated point is a global maximum because $|g| \le 1$ and $\max_R 2R^2e^{-R^2} = 2/e$. The mean geometry and history estimates follow from the same helical symmetry and amplitude bounds as in Proposition 11. □

This excludes compulsory depletion of the maximum mean circulation as an explanation of the positive stretching event. It does not show unbounded circulation for a single datum: the initial peak itself grows like λ^{2h}, and the finite increase is paid at the same order as the critical defect history. A quantitative recurrent estimate with the full initial datum remains a separate question.

7.7 Persistent mean geometry suppresses a competing fast phase

The generated mean mode also gives a positive conditional estimate. Within the fixed two-parent family, a uniform bound on the mean's axial curvature forces one parent to be small enough that removing it costs vanishing critical velocity history.

Use the profiles W_2, W_4 and the envelope g from (44). For complex amplitudes a, b with $|a|, |b| \le 1$, set

$$\delta = \lambda^{-2h}, \qquad \mu = \lambda\delta, \qquad C_{a,b} = \pi \|g\|_2^2 \left(1 + \frac{3}{4}|a|^2 + \frac{21}{20}|b|^2\right), \qquad A = \frac{\lambda^{1+2h}}{\sqrt{C_{a,b}}},$$
$$u_\lambda(0, x_h, z) = Ag(\mu z)\left[V_h(\lambda x_h) + \mathrm{Re}\left((aW_2 + bW_4)(\lambda x_h)e^{2i\lambda z}\right)\right].$$

The normalization is uniform over the amplitude disks, and the initial squared energy is λ^{-1+6h}.

Proposition 15. *Fix $\nu > 0$ and $0 < h \le 1/6$. There are constants $s_* > 0$, $C < \infty$ and a lower threshold on λ, uniform over $|a|, |b| \le 1$, with the following properties. The actual unforced flow exists through $t_\lambda = s_*/(A\lambda)$. Put*

$$\tau_\lambda = \lambda^{-2} - t_\lambda, \qquad M_\lambda = \tau_\lambda^{3/2-h} \sup_{0 \le z \le \pi/\lambda} \left|\partial_{zz}(\mathcal{P}u_\lambda)_\theta(\lambda^{-1}, z, t_\lambda)\right|.$$

Then

$$|a|^2|b| \le C(1 + M_\lambda)\lambda^{-4h}. \tag{61}$$

Let v_λ be the actual unforced solution obtained by deleting the smaller of the two initial amplitudes, while retaining the original A, μ and ν. It exists on the same interval and satisfies

$$\int_0^{t_\lambda} \|u_\lambda - v_\lambda\|_\infty^2 \, \mathrm{d}t \le C(1 + M_\lambda)^{2/3}\lambda^{-2h/3}. \tag{62}$$

In particular a bounded M_λ makes this critical comparison history tend to zero.

Proof. Work in the extended variables, with $D_3 = \delta\partial_Z + 2\partial_\alpha$ and $\eta = \nu\lambda/A$. Treat δ and η as independent fixed parameters when differentiating the amplitudes. The local Sobolev estimates used in Proposition 10 are uniform over the two amplitude disks and $0 \le \delta, \eta \le 1$. In particular they bound three time derivatives and three mixed amplitude derivatives in enough spatial regularity for the following point evaluations. Starting in H^{30} leaves ample margin even when each viscous time derivative uses two spatial derivatives.

Write

$$G(R, Z, \alpha, s) = R(\mathcal{P}U)_\theta(R, Z, \alpha, s), \qquad G_{\mathrm{f}} = G - \frac{1}{2\pi}\int_0^{2\pi} G \, \mathrm{d}\alpha.$$

If either parent is absent, its preserved joint rotation–phase symmetry makes G independent of α, so $G_{\mathrm{f}} = 0$. Rotation through $\pi/2$ changes a to $-a$ and leaves b unchanged; angular averaging therefore makes G_{f} even in a. Fix the two complex phases and vary the real magnitudes through zero. Taylor's formula twice in the first magnitude and once in the second gives the factored bounds

$$\|G_{\mathrm{f}}\|_{C^3} + \left\|\partial_s^3 G_{\mathrm{f}}\right\|_{C^3} \le C|a|^2|b| \tag{63}$$

on a fixed annulus around $R = 1$. These are bounds for the actual nonlinear evolution. They do not presume convergence of an infinite amplitude expansion. The constants are uniform in the two phases.

Let

$$F_1(s) = \frac{1}{2\pi}\int_0^{2\pi} e^{-i\alpha} G(1,0,\alpha,s)\,\mathrm{d}\alpha.$$

Exactly $F_1(0) = F_1'(0) = 0$. The phase labels show that its only cubic ancestry in the second time derivative is $W_2, W_2, \overline{W_4}$. The viscous terms there have degree at most two in the datum, and cannot reach angular index zero and axial index one. Consequently

$$F_1''(0) = \frac{1}{8} a^2 \bar{b}\, \mathcal{C}_\delta(1,0), \qquad \mathcal{C}_\delta(1,0) \longrightarrow -\frac{32}{5e^3} \quad (\delta \to 0).$$

The limit is the complete pressure calculation in Proposition 10, with $g(0) = 1$. The convergence follows from the uniformly bounded, strongly convergent extended Leray multipliers on these fixed smooth inputs. The amplitude factor is exact, so the convergence is uniform even when one amplitude tends to zero much faster than the other. There is no η contribution to this second derivative. Equation (63) and Taylor's formula in time now give a fixed sufficiently small $s_* > 0$ and

$$|F_1(s_*)| \geq c|a|^2|b| \tag{64}$$

for all sufficiently small δ and $0 \leq \eta \leq 1$.

The physical restriction must be kept in this estimate. At $r = \lambda^{-1}$ and $0 \leq z \leq \pi/\lambda$ it is $Z = \delta\alpha/2$, $\alpha = 2\lambda z$, and $G = (\mathcal{P}U)_\theta$ because $R = 1$. Since τ_λ is comparable to λ^{-2}, the definition of M_λ implies

$$|D_3^2 G(1, \delta\alpha/2, \alpha, s_*)| \leq C M_\lambda \delta^2, \qquad 0 \leq \alpha \leq 2\pi.$$

Multiply by $e^{-i\alpha}$ and average over this interval. The α-independent part of G contributes $O(\delta^2)$, using its uniform Z derivatives. For G_{f}, replacing $Z = \delta\alpha/2$ by $Z = 0$ in the leading $4\partial_{\alpha\alpha}$ term costs $O(\delta|a|^2|b|)$ by (63). The terms $4\delta\partial_{Z\alpha}$ and $\delta^2\partial_{ZZ}$ cost the same or less. The leading averaged term is $-4F_1(s_*)$. Hence

$$4c|a|^2|b| \leq C(1 + M_\lambda)\delta^2 + C\delta|a|^2|b|.$$

Absorb the last term for small δ. This proves (61) directly on the physical field; no persistence of compact slow Fourier support has been assumed.

Finally retain the original A and η in the one-parent reference. The amplitude derivative estimates give $\sup_{0\leq s\leq s_*} \left\|U - U^{\mathrm{ref}}\right\|_\infty \leq C\min(|a|,|b|)$. Physical rescaling and $\min(|a|,|b|)^3 \leq |a|^2|b|$ yield

$$\int_0^{t_\lambda} \|u_\lambda - v_\lambda\|_\infty^2 \,\mathrm{d}t \leq C\frac{A}{\lambda}\min(|a|,|b|)^2 \leq C\delta^{-1}\big((1+M_\lambda)\delta^2\big)^{2/3}.$$

This is (62). □

This comparison concerns one fixed two-parent family and one short normalized interval. The reference preserves a single joint fast phase in the extended variables; its slow envelope prevents identifying it with an exact globally helical whole-space flow. Moreover $u_\lambda - v_\lambda$ is not the angular fluctuation $u_\lambda - \mathcal{P}u_\lambda$. Theorem 1 therefore cannot be applied by substituting this different error. Arbitrary-data decomposition, repeated changes of reference, and a uniform long-time bound for the reference itself remain open.

7.8 Delayed mean production limits the phase reduction

The conclusion of Proposition 15 depends on its two fixed profiles. Higher angular indices can delay the first fast mean interaction, while both parents retain a nonvanishing critical comparison cost. The following example retains all the mean bounds, not only the single observable M_λ.

With $q = y_1 + iy_2$, define

$$Z_6 = \operatorname{curl}_h\left(\tfrac{1}{8} q^6 e^{-|y_h|^2} e_z\right), \qquad Z_8 = \operatorname{curl}_h\left(\tfrac{1}{32} q^8 e^{-|y_h|^2} e_z\right).$$

Keep the preceding g, V_h, δ, μ, but now put

$$\epsilon = \sqrt{\delta} = \lambda^{-h}, \qquad C_\epsilon = \pi \|g\|_2^2 \left(1 + \frac{5355}{4096}\epsilon^2\right), \qquad A = \lambda^{1+2h}/\sqrt{C_\epsilon}.$$

The initial data are

$$u_\lambda(0, x_h, z) = A g(\mu z)\left[V_h(\lambda x_h) + \epsilon \operatorname{Re}\left((Z_6 + Z_8)(\lambda x_h) e^{2i\lambda z}\right)\right]. \tag{65}$$

Let $v_\lambda^{(j)}$, $j = 6, 8$, denote the unforced evolution obtained by retaining only Z_j, with the same A, μ, ν as the full datum.

Proposition 16. *Fix $\nu > 0$ and $0 < h \le 1/6$. There are $s_*, c, C > 0$ and a lower threshold on λ such that all three actual unforced flows exist on $0 \le t \le t_\lambda = s_*/(A\lambda)$. The datum (65) has squared energy $\lambda^{-1+6h} \le 1$ and*

$$\frac{\|u_\lambda(0) - \mathcal{P}u_\lambda(0)\|_2}{\|\mathcal{P}u_\lambda(0)\|_2} = \sqrt{\frac{5355}{4096}}\epsilon \longrightarrow 0.$$

Its actual angular mean satisfies all of (1)–(2) throughout this interval, with $\tau = \lambda^{-2} - t$ and a constant independent of λ. Nevertheless, for both $j = 6, 8$,

$$c \le \int_0^{t_\lambda} \left\| u_\lambda - v_\lambda^{(j)} \right\|_\infty^2 \, \mathrm{d}t \le C. \tag{66}$$

The same upper and lower bounds hold for the angular fluctuation $u_\lambda - \mathcal{P}u_\lambda$.

Proof. Use the extended equation with $D_3 = \delta\partial_Z + 2\partial_\alpha$ and $\eta = \nu\lambda/A$, as in Proposition 10. The initial datum is $g(Z)[V_h + \epsilon \operatorname{Re}((Z_6 + Z_8)e^{i\alpha})]$. The same uniform local estimates give all three flows on a common interval. Holding δ, η fixed, take seven finite amplitude derivatives. The differentiated transport estimates give uniform H^{30-2j} bounds for $\partial_\epsilon^j U$, $0 \le j \le 7$. The remaining H^{16} regularity controls the spatial derivatives used below. This requires only finite differentiability in lower Sobolev spaces.

At zero amplitude the evolving base has phase label $(0, 0)$. Its linearization preserves the covariant angular and axial phase labels. Quadratic interactions add them. Induction in the differentiated equation therefore puts the jth amplitude derivative at zero in the j-fold sumset of

$$(6, 1), \quad (-6, -1), \quad (8, 1), \quad (-8, -1).$$

If a product uses signed multiplicities a, b, an angular mean requires $6a + 8b = 0$, whence $a = 4k$, $b = -3k$. Its axial index is $a + b = k$, and it uses at least $|a| + |b| = 7|k|$ factors. Thus no amplitude derivative of order at most six has an angular mean with nonzero axial index. Taylor's theorem gives

$$\|(\mathcal{P}U)_{\mathrm{f}}\|_{C^2} \le C\epsilon^7 = C\delta^{7/2}, \tag{67}$$

where the subscript removes the average over α. No nonzero seventh-order interaction coefficient is asserted or needed.

Write v^0 for the α average of $\mathcal{P}U$. Its divergence constraint gives

$$v_r^0(R,Z,s) = -\frac{\delta}{R}\int_0^R \rho\,\partial_Z v_z^0(\rho,Z,s)\,\mathrm{d}\rho.$$

For $R \le 1$ the primitive and its differentiated forms give the $O(\delta)$ radial bound. For $R \ge 1$, Cauchy–Schwarz with radial measure $\rho\,\mathrm{d}\rho$ and the uniform horizontal L^2 slice bounds gives the same estimate; the divergence identity then bounds its radial derivatives. The needed Z derivatives obey the same estimates. Since v^0 is independent of α, each D_3 derivative gives an additional factor δ. The other two components have uniform spatial bounds. Combining these estimates with (67), and using $\delta^{7/2} \le \delta^3$ for $0 < \delta \le 1$, yields, for $a + b \le 2$,

$$|\partial_R^a D_3^b(\mathcal{P}U)_r| \le C\delta^{b+1}, \qquad |\partial_R^a D_3^b(\mathcal{P}U)_\theta| + |\partial_R^a D_3^b(\mathcal{P}U)_z| \le C\delta^b.$$

Physical rescaling gives exactly (1)–(2). For large λ, $t_\lambda < \lambda^{-2}/2$, so replacing λ^{-2} by $\lambda^{-2} - t$ only enlarges their right-hand sides.

The horizontal squared energies of the real Z_6, Z_8, divided by π, are respectively $315/512$ and $2835/4096$. Angular orthogonality gives the stated normalization and relative defect. At $(R,\phi,Z,\alpha) = (1,0,0,0)$ their real velocities are $(0,-1/(2e),0)$ and $(0,-3/(16e),0)$. Consequently the initial difference from either deletion reference, and the initial full angular fluctuation, have magnitude at least $c\epsilon$ there. First amplitude and time derivative estimates bound the time derivatives of these differences by $C\epsilon$. After reducing the common s_*, the pointwise lower bounds persist; the corresponding supremum upper bounds are also $C\epsilon$. The point on the physical trace is $(\lambda^{-1},0,0)$. Finally

$$\frac{A\epsilon^2}{\lambda} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{C_\epsilon}}$$

is bounded above and below by positive constants. Changing from s to physical time proves (66) and its angular-fluctuation counterpart. □

The finite phase count is kernel-checked in `MettapediaNS.HelicalPhaseSelection`; the Gaussian normalizations are checked by `helical_phase_delay.py` with rational arithmetic. The PDE argument above is analytic, not formalized in that module. For angular indices $2k, 2(k+1)$ the same count requires at least $2k+1$ factors for a fast angular mean. This arithmetic statement does not give estimates uniform in k.

Thus persistent mean geometry does not, for arbitrary pairs of profiles, force the comparison history of either deletion reference to vanish. This does not exclude every possible reference class. All the histories here are finite, so the example is consistent with Theorem 1; it supplies neither an infinite sequence of concentrating events from one datum nor a singularity.

The same mechanism applies to any fixed finite number of mean derivatives. Increasing the amplitude within the geometric allowance then makes the critical history diverge across the data family.

Corollary 17. *Fix an integer $K \ge 2$, $\nu > 0$, and $0 < h \le 1/6$. There is a family of real Schwartz solenoidal data of squared energy $\lambda^{-1+6h} \le 1$, whose relative L^2 angular defect tends to zero, with the following properties. Their actual unforced flows exist through $t_\lambda = s_*/(A\lambda)$, where $s_* > 0$ is independent of λ and A is comparable to λ^{1+2h}. The angular means satisfy (1)–(2) for* every *$a + b \le K$, with $\tau = \lambda^{-2} - t$ and a constant independent of λ. Nevertheless*

$$c\lambda^{2h/(2K+3)} \le \int_0^{t_\lambda} \|u_\lambda - \mathcal{P}u_\lambda\|_\infty^2\,\mathrm{d}t \le C\lambda^{2h/(2K+3)}. \tag{68}$$

The same bounds hold for the difference from either of the two one-parent deletion references used in the construction below. Constants may depend on K; no uniformity as $K \to \infty$ is asserted.

Proof. Put $m = 2K + 2$, $p = 2K + 3$, and

$$d_j = \frac{(j+1)!}{2^{j+1}}, \qquad \widehat{Z}_j = d_j^{-1/2} \operatorname{curl}_h(q^j e^{-|y_h|^2} e_z), \quad j = m, m+2.$$

The horizontal squared energy of each real $\widehat{Z}_j$ is π. Use the datum (65) with $Z_6 + Z_8$ replaced by $\widehat{Z}_m + \widehat{Z}_{m+2}$, and now choose

$$\delta = \lambda^{-2h}, \qquad \epsilon = \delta^{(K+1)/p}, \qquad C_\epsilon = \pi \|g\|_2^2 (1 + 2\epsilon^2), \qquad A = \lambda^{1+2h}/\sqrt{C_\epsilon}.$$

The relative initial defect is exactly $\sqrt{2}\epsilon$. Retain this A and the same viscosity in both deletion references.

For these two angular indices, the phase-count theorem with $k = K + 1$ excludes a fast angular mean before amplitude order p. Start the extended construction in H^{2p+K+8} and take p finite amplitude derivatives. The differentiated estimates leave H^{K+8} regularity, more than needed for the uniform C^K bound. Thus

$$\|(\mathcal{P}U)_{\mathrm{f}}\|_{C^K} \le C\epsilon^p = C\delta^{K+1}.$$

The slow mean retains the radial primitive and axial derivative gains in the preceding proof. For $b \le K$, $\delta^{K+1} \le \delta^{b+1} \le \delta^b$, so the fast part pays every required mean derivative as well.

At $(R, \phi, Z, \alpha) = (1, 0, 0, 0)$ the two real azimuthal velocities are $-(j-2)/(e\sqrt{d_j})$, both strictly negative. The same pointwise persistence argument gives upper and lower bounds of order ϵ for the fluctuation and for the differences from either reference, on a common smaller interval. Their physical histories are therefore comparable to

$$\frac{A}{\lambda}\epsilon^2 = \frac{\delta^{-1+2(K+1)/p}}{\sqrt{C_\epsilon}} = \frac{\lambda^{2h/(2K+3)}}{\sqrt{C_\epsilon}}.$$

This proves (68). □

Already $K = 2$ gives histories of order $\lambda^{2h/7}$ despite uniform mean geometry and a relative defect tending to zero. Thus no bound uniform over these data follows from bounded kinetic energy, an upper bound on the interval length, small relative defect, and any fixed finite set of these mean derivative bounds alone. The higher norms of the initial data grow with λ. A finite allowance depending on the full initial datum, uniform over all shorter evolution intervals from that datum, remains unrefuted.

7.9 Circulation and total enstrophy can grow during the delayed interaction

The large critical histories above need not be accompanied by a loss of mean circulation. The same profiles give positive full enstrophy production and raise the mean circulation above its initial maximum.

Corollary 18. *In the family of Corollary 17, after decreasing the fixed $s_* > 0$ and increasing the lower threshold on λ if necessary, put $\Gamma_\lambda = r(\mathcal{P}u_\lambda)_\theta$. Then*

$$\Gamma_\lambda(\lambda^{-1}, 0, t_\lambda) - \sup_{r,z} \Gamma_\lambda(r, z, 0) \ge c\lambda^{2h/(2K+3)}, \tag{69}$$

$$\tfrac{1}{2}\|\nabla u_\lambda(t_\lambda)\|_2^2 - \tfrac{1}{2}\|\nabla u_\lambda(0)\|_2^2 \ge c\lambda^{1+4h+2h/(2K+3)}. \tag{70}$$

All the mean derivative bounds and history estimates of that corollary continue to hold. The full integrated viscous enstrophy dissipation obeys

$$\nu \int_0^{t_\lambda} \|\Delta u_\lambda\|_2^2 \, \mathrm{d}t \le C\nu\lambda^{1+4h}.$$

Thus the signed nonlinear production in the full enstrophy identity exceeds this dissipation by the amount in (70).

Proof. First compute the two signs for one unnormalized parent $f_m(r)e^{i(m\phi+2z)}$, where $f_m = r^m e^{-r^2}$ and $m \ge 6$, about the same Gaussian swirl. Write

$$\Omega = 2e^{-r^2}, \quad \zeta = 4(1-r^2)e^{-r^2}, \quad L_m = \partial_{rr} + r^{-1}\partial_r - m^2 r^{-2}, \quad q_m = r^m e^{-2r^2}, \quad \mathcal{R}_m = (-L_m+4)^{-1}.$$

The full linear-pressure source and its smooth decaying solution are

$$\begin{aligned} S_m &= 8(4r^2 + m^2 - 3m - 2)q_m, \\ p_m &= -2q_m + \gamma_m \mathcal{R}_m q_m, \qquad \gamma_m = 8(m^2 - m + 1). \end{aligned}$$

Indeed $(-L_m + 4)p_m = S_m$ follows by differentiation. The complete mean stress derivative is

$$T_m = \frac{1}{2}\left[2\Omega(f_m')^2 - \frac{m^2\zeta f_m^2}{r^2} + f_m' p_m' - \frac{m^2 f_m p_m}{r^2}\right].$$

As in (60), the circulation acceleration divided by ϵ^2 at $r = 1$ is

$$\sigma_m = -\frac{1}{r}\partial_r(r^2 T_m)\Big|_{r=1} = \frac{4m(m-4)}{e^3} - \frac{2(m-2)}{e}p_m(1) + \frac{2m}{e}p_m'(1).$$

The heat formula

$$e^{sL_m} q_m = r^m (1+8s)^{-m-1} e^{-2r^2/(1+8s)}$$

identifies the resolvent and its radial derivative. With $a = 1 + 8s$, substitution gives

$$\sigma_m = \frac{4(m-2)}{e^3} + \frac{\gamma_m}{e}\int_0^\infty e^{-4s} a^{-m-1} e^{-2/a}\left[2m\left(m - \frac{4}{a}\right) - 2(m-2)\right] \mathrm{d}s.$$

The bracket is at least $2(m^2 - 5m + 2) > 0$ for $m \ge 5$. In particular $\sigma_m > 4(m-2)e^{-3} > 0$.

The sign of total enstrophy work requires a separate calculation. Retaining all parent-vorticity components and the full pressure pairing, the coefficient of ϵ^2 in the derivative of the initial nonlinear production is

$$\chi_m = 4\pi I_m + 8\pi \int_0^\infty e^{-4s} J_m(s) \, \mathrm{d}s,$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} I_m &= \int_0^\infty r(-4r^2 e^{-r^2})\left(\frac{m^2\zeta f_m^2}{r^2} - 2\Omega(f_m')^2\right) \mathrm{d}r = d_m \frac{(m-1)(m-2)}{2^m}, \\ J_m(s) &= \int_0^\infty r\zeta' f_m'(e^{sL_m} S_m) \, \mathrm{d}r, \qquad d_m = \frac{(m+1)!}{2^{m+1}}. \end{aligned}$$

These are the general-angular-index forms of the complete identities used in Proposition 13. The pressure term need not be positive. Its negative part can be paid explicitly. Gaussian integration yields

$$\frac{J_m(s)}{d_m} = -\frac{16P_m(a)}{(m+1)(a+1)^{m+4}},$$

with

$$P_m(a) = 2m(m-1)^2a^3 + (-m^4+6m^3-15m^2+6m+4)a^2 \\ + (-m^4+10m^3-13m^2+8m+8)a + 4m^3 - 14m^2 - 18m - 8.$$

For $m \geq 6$ and $a \geq 1$, its quadratic coefficient is negative, its linear coefficient is at most $2m^3+20$, and its constant coefficient is at most $4m^3$. Hence

$$P_m(a) \leq 2m(m-1)^2a^3 + (2m^3+20)a + 4m^3.$$

Use this positive majorant to give a nonpositive lower bound for $J_m(s)$, and discard e^{-4s} only from that lower bound. The resulting three elementary integrals give

$$2\int_0^\infty e^{-4s}J_m(s)\,\mathrm{d}s \geq -I_m\rho_m, \qquad \rho_m = \frac{4m^5+18m^4+23m^3+3m^2-14m+88}{(m-2)(m-1)(m+1)^2(m+2)(m+3)} < 1.$$

For example, writing $j = m-6 \geq 0$, the numerator of $1-\rho_m$ over the displayed positive denominator is

$$j^6 + 36j^5 + 520j^4 + 3797j^3 + 14332j^2 + 24594j + 11048,$$

which is strictly positive. Consequently

$$\chi_m \geq 4\pi I_m(1-\rho_m) > 0 \qquad (m \geq 6). \tag{71}$$

The checker `helical_high_mode_feedback.py` verifies the pressure equation, full stress and vorticity identities, heat formulas, Gaussian reductions and polynomial sign certificates exactly. The Lean module `MettapediaNS.HelicalHighModeFeedback` checks the circulation heat bracket and $\rho_m < 1$. Its scope is these algebraic signs; the integral identities and evolution estimates remain analytic.

Return to the normalized two-parent data of Corollary 17, with $m = 2K+2$ and $p = 2K+3$. At quadratic amplitude order, angular orthogonality adds the two coefficients: the circulation coefficient is $\sigma_m/d_m + \sigma_{m+2}/d_{m+2} > 0$, and the enstrophy coefficient is $\chi_m/d_m + \chi_{m+2}/d_{m+2} > 0$. There is no angular mean at first amplitude order, and every angular mean at second order has zero axial phase. Thus the quadratic coefficients in both observables are independent of the fast phase after angular integration. Restriction to the physical trace creates no rapid-phase averaging error at this order.

Here is the uniform time argument. At zero amplitude, the frozen field $g(Z)V_h$ has pressure $-g(Z)^2e^{-2r^2}$ at $\delta = \eta = 0$. In the extended equation at nonzero δ, η its residual has Sobolev norm $O(\delta+\eta)$: the omitted axial pressure derivative carries δ, and diffusion carries η. The local transport stability estimate therefore keeps the base within $O(\delta+\eta)$ of this stationary field on the common interval. In particular both its circulation and its normalized enstrophy change by $O(\delta+\eta)$.

Take three finite amplitude derivatives of the actual extended flow, holding δ and η fixed. Taylor's theorem gives each observable's increment as its base increment plus a quadratic coefficient times ϵ^2, with remainder $O(\epsilon^3)$, uniformly on a common interval. The physical L^2 remainder is controlled by the periodic-variable trace estimate already used in Proposition 9. The quadratic coefficients converge as $(\delta,\eta) \to (0,0)$ by the bounded strong convergence of the Leray multipliers and the differentiated local evolution equations. Their phase independence just established also justifies this convergence for the physical enstrophy integral.

At that limit, both increments and their first time derivatives vanish at $s = 0$: the initial mean stress is zero, and the quadratic initial total production is the real part of a purely imaginary

pairing. Their second derivatives are the positive coefficients above; for the enstrophy integral there is the additional positive factor $\int g^4$. Choose a fixed small $s_* > 0$ for which both quadratic increments are positive. For small δ, η, both actual increments are consequently at least

$$c\epsilon^2 - C(\delta + \eta) - C\epsilon^3.$$

Since $\epsilon^2 = \delta^{1-1/p}$ and $\eta = \nu\sqrt{C_\epsilon}\delta$, this is at least $c'\epsilon^2$ for all sufficiently large λ.

Circulation rescales by A/λ and enstrophy by A^2/μ. Therefore their respective increments are bounded below by constants times

$$\frac{A}{\lambda}\epsilon^2 \asymp \lambda^{2h/p}, \qquad \frac{A^2}{\mu}\epsilon^2 \asymp \lambda^{1+4h+2h/p}.$$

Initially $(r, z) = (\lambda^{-1}, 0)$ is a global circulation maximum, since $|g| \le 1$ and $\max_R 2R^2 e^{-R^2} = 2/e$. This proves (69)–(70). Finally the uniform spatial Sobolev and trace estimates bound the integrated dissipation by $C\nu A\lambda/\mu = C\nu A/\delta \le C'\nu\lambda^{1+4h}$. □

Thus controlled mean geometry, small relative defect, and incompatible phases can coexist with a growing circulation peak and net total enstrophy gain. These are finite events across different initial data. The initial circulation peak and enstrophy grow faster than their increments, and no repeated growth from one fixed datum is established.

7.10 A parent velocity need not decorrelate

The positivity calculation does not imply that the parents soon disappear from the critical velocity norm. There is a simple obstruction already in the exact linearized equation.

Proposition 19. *Fix an integer $m \ge 3$ and put $d_m = (m+1)!/2^{m+1}$. On $\mathbb{R}^2 \times (\mathbb{R}/\pi\mathbb{Z})$, let w_m solve the inviscid linearized equation about $V_h = 2re^{-r^2}e_\theta$, with initial datum $\mathrm{Re}(\widehat{Z}_m e^{2iz})$ from Corollary 17. Then, for every $s \ge 0$,*

$$\sup_{\phi,z} |w_m(1, \phi, z, s)| \ge c_m := \frac{2(m-2)}{e\sqrt{d_m}\sqrt{4+m^2}} > 0. \tag{72}$$

In particular $\int_0^T \|w_m\|_\infty^2 \, \mathrm{d}s \ge c_m^2 T$.

Let $w_{m,\eta}$ instead be the viscous linearization, with the same initial datum, about the actual heat-evolved swirl

$$V_\eta(r, s) = \frac{2r}{(1+4\eta s)^2} e^{-r^2/(1+4\eta s)} e_\theta.$$

There are constants $a_m, b_m, \eta_m > 0$ such that, for $0 < \eta < \eta_m$,

$$\int_0^{a_m \log(1/\eta)} \|w_{m,\eta}\|_\infty^2 \, \mathrm{d}s \ge b_m \log(1/\eta). \tag{73}$$

In particular these histories have no bound uniform in both time and positive viscosity.

Proof. Write the complex cylindrical mode of w_m as $(Ae_r + Be_\theta + Ce_z)e^{im\phi+2iz}$, and its pressure coefficient as P. Put $\Omega = 2e^{-r^2}$ and $\zeta = 4(1-r^2)e^{-r^2}$. The tangential and axial equations are

$$B_s + im\Omega B + \zeta A = -\frac{im}{r}P, \qquad C_s + im\Omega C = -2iP.$$

Their combination $Q = 2rB - mC$ satisfies

$$Q_s + im\Omega Q = -2r\zeta A.$$

At the initial peak-circulation circle $r = 1$, $\zeta = 0$. Thus $Q(1, s) = e^{-2ims/e}Q(1, 0)$, with $Q(1, 0) = -2(m - 2)/(e\sqrt{d_m})$. The Gram identity

$$(4 + m^2)(|B|^2 + |C|^2) - |2B - mC|^2 = |mB + 2C|^2$$

gives the corresponding complex velocity lower bound. For the real field, choose the angular phase so that $Qe^{im\phi+2iz}$ is real with maximal modulus, and apply the same real linear functional $2w_\theta - mw_z$. This proves (72).

The smooth linearized solutions exist on every finite interval by the H^j transport estimate. Fix an integer $j \geq 3$. The background Sobolev norms are bounded uniformly in time and $0 \leq \eta \leq 1$, while $\|w_m(s)\|_{H^{j+2}} \leq Ce^{Cs}$ and $\|V_\eta(s) - V_h\|_{H^{j+1}} \leq C\eta s$ by the heat formula. The equation for their difference has forcing $\eta\Delta w_m$ and the two linear advection terms containing $V_\eta - V_h$. The same transport estimate, with the viscous dissipation retained on the left, therefore gives

$$\|w_{m,\eta}(s) - w_m(s)\|_{H^j} \leq C\eta(1 + s)^2 e^{Cs}.$$

All constants here depend only on the fixed parent and Sobolev order. Choose $a_m > 0$ sufficiently small that the exponential factor on $0 \leq s \leq a_m \log(1/\eta)$ is at most $\eta^{-1/2}$. Sobolev embedding then makes the velocity difference at most $c_m/2$ throughout that interval, once η is small enough. Integrating the resulting lower bound proves (73), with $b_m = a_m c_m^2/4$. □

The `HelicalParentMomentum` module in `MettapediaNS` checks the pressure cancellation, the scalar rotating-momentum ODE and its norm conservation, and the Gram inequality. The cylindrical PDE derivation and the viscous comparison above are analytic. This is a statement about linear variations on the periodic cylinder, not a nonlinear remainder estimate, a whole-space background, or recurrent concentration in one solution. It excludes a viscosity-uniform parent-history argument based simply on decay of the linearized velocity supremum.

7.11 The energy inequality alone permits the stress cost

The time-integrated energy inequality cannot by itself exclude the cost in (14). An explicit path shows this while keeping all the mean geometry bounds. This path is not a Navier–Stokes solution. Use W_+ from Proposition 7, choose $0 < h < 1/4$, and set

$$\alpha = \tfrac{1}{2} - 2h, \qquad c^2 = \frac{160\nu}{3\alpha}, \qquad d^2 = \frac{8\nu}{\alpha}, \qquad A_0 = (\tfrac{9}{2}g_2 c^2 d)^{-1/2}.$$

For $0 < \tau \leq 1$ define the whole-space smooth solenoidal path

$$u(x, -\tau) = A_0\tau^{-1/2-h/2}W_+\left(\frac{x_1}{c\sqrt{\tau}}, \frac{x_2}{c\sqrt{\tau}}, \frac{z}{d\tau^{1/2-h}}\right).$$

It has zero angular mean. Its squared velocity norm E and squared gradient norm D are exactly

$$E(-\tau) = \tau^\alpha, \qquad D(-\tau) = E(-\tau)\left(\frac{20}{3c^2\tau} + \frac{1}{d^2\tau^{1-2h}}\right).$$

Since $t = -\tau$, these imply

$$\tfrac{1}{2}E'(t) + \nu D(t) = \frac{\alpha E(t)}{8\tau}(\tau^{2h} - 3) < 0, \qquad \nu\int_{-1}^{0} D(t)\,\mathrm{d}t = \frac{1 - 2h}{4} < \infty.$$

Thus the path starts with unit squared velocity norm and satisfies the energy inequality on every time interval, with finite total dissipation. On sufficiently late slices,

$$K(-\tau) = A_0 \|W_+\|_{L^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3)} \tau^{-1/2-h/2},$$

so the critical history is infinite. Its radial–azimuthal stress has supremum $2A_0^2 e^{-2}\tau^{-1-h}$ and its axial–azimuthal stress is zero, so

$$\mathcal{B}_\tau(T) = \frac{2A_0^2 e^{-2}}{h}(1 - T^{-h}) > 0$$

for fixed $T > 1$ and sufficiently small τ. The stress maximum then lies in $B(1)$ throughout the interval.

The strict energy loss already shows why this is not an unforced smooth solution, which would satisfy energy equality. Its zero mean also has nonzero Reynolds torque, so an original force would be needed to keep that mean zero. The example only separates the energy inequality and mean geometry from the actual evolution required to control the history.

8 Scope of the calculation

The theorem allows an unbounded angular fluctuation, but requires its history to satisfy (3) and separately assumes the mean geometry. Neither hypothesis is established here for general data. Theorem 5 separately supplies a quantitative gradient history under a stronger weighted amplitude condition. Its localization constants may depend on the solution on a regular annulus; they are not uniform data-only bounds. In Theorem 1, an original force uniformly bounded in spatial C^2 on Q can also be included: its rescaled swirl and vorticity sources vanish, and its enstrophy contribution is bounded by $C(Y + 1)$. Thus a distinction between forced and unforced flows must enter a proof of the hypotheses, not be inferred from this criterion.

The accompanying symbolic calculation checks the mean equation, cylindrical stress divergence, lifted force identity, and the stretching integration by parts on explicit polynomial fields with all six stress components nonzero. It also checks the general cylindrical stretching and local radial integration identities, and the Gaussian moments and complete convection work in Proposition 7. The polynomial fields are local algebra tests, whereas the Gaussian fields are finite-energy initial data. It also checks the signed dual-work integrations and the scaling of the final kinematic path. That path is explicitly distinct from the actual unforced initial jets. The program does not integrate solutions or certify the analytic proof. No statement in this note has been added as an axiom or a theorem to the Lean library.

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